

Structural reduction of the SI base of units via the Cosserat-continuum hypothesis: electromagnetic and gravitational quantities as mechanical objects of an elastic medium

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Abstract

The idea of interpreting the electromagnetic field as a deformation of an elastic medium is an old one: Maxwell himself derived his equations from exactly such a model (1861–1862), and the late-nineteenth-century aether program developed it further. Much later, Kleinert (1989–2008) showed that **gravitation** admits an analogous interpretation, by way of disclination defects in an elastic continuum, in the form of Einstein–Cartan theory. The two programs developed in parallel and almost never met; no consistent treatment is available in the literature in which both sectors live in a single Cosserat continuum together with an explicit reduction of the SI units. The present work proposes such a unification.

The framework rests on four identifications between parameters of the medium and the fundamental constants of nature:

- **P1:** $\rho_{\text{medium}} \equiv \mu_0$ — the density of the medium is identified with the magnetic permeability;
- **P2:** $G_{\text{shear}} \equiv 1/\epsilon_0$ — the shear modulus with the inverse electric permittivity;
- **P3:** $\hbar$ — the quantum of action of microrotations of the medium;
- **P4:** G enters through the Kleinert gauge mechanism (u -channel of translations).

Already from P1 and P2 the speed of the transverse Cosserat wave comes out exactly equal to the speed of light: $c_T = \sqrt{G_{\text{shear}}/\rho} = 1/\sqrt{\epsilon_0\mu_0} \equiv c_{\text{light}}$ — with no tuning, using the bare experimental values of μ_0, ϵ_0 . From there everything unfolds on its own: the ampere becomes a deformation circulation with dimension $[m^2/s]$, the coulomb becomes the cross-sectional area of a defect $[m^2]$, and the whole base $\{m, kg, s, A\}$ reduces to a single dimension — length (or, equivalently, energy). The gravitational constant acquires the structural form $G = c^4\epsilon_0/(16\pi l_G^2)$, where $l_G \approx 4.62 \times 10^{15} m$ is the characteristic scale of the u -channel; the famous Planck length turns out **not** to be fundamental but derived: $l_P = l_0^2/(2\sqrt{2} \cdot l_G)$.

Local minima of the functional and identification with particles. In the same structure (P1–P4 plus the geometry of an S^2 -target director field) the functional $E[n, u]$ admits stable localized minima with integer topological charge $Q_H \in \pi_3(S^2) = \mathbb{Z}$ — a consequence of the medium itself, not an extra postulate. Empirically the minimum with $Q_H = -1$ is identified with the electron (the one with $Q_H = +1$ with the positron); direct numerical relaxation yields a mass consistent with the experimental $m_e \approx 511 \text{ keV}$ [10]. In this sense the program contains no "separate predictions" stacked on top of the postulates: there is one cascade of consequences from the structure of the medium, and the existence of particles as topological knots of the field is one of its links — on a par with $c = c_{\text{light}}$, the dimensional reduction, and the value of α .

Combined with the dimensional reduction $[Q] \leftrightarrow [m^2]$, this yields a direct numerical consequence. The cross-section of a hopfionic defect under the Derrick-stability condition is a disc of radius $r_v = l_0/2$ (§7.3); the charge is then the area of that disc, $e = \pi(l_0/2)^2$. Substituting into the textbook definition $\alpha = e^2/(4\pi\epsilon_0\hbar c)$, after cancellations one obtains

> $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$ (derivation in Section 7)

— a **bare** value of the fine-structure constant, obtained without using the experimental α on the right-hand side. Agreement with the measured $\alpha(M_Z) = 1/128.9$ at the Z-boson scale is 0.7%. The discrepancy with the familiar low-energy value $1/137$ is the standard QED renormalization through vacuum polarization by virtual pairs; in our picture $1/128$ plays the role of a UV boundary condition for the renormalization-group equations.

The bottom line in one sentence: the canonical set of fundamental constants of nature reduces to $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar, G\}$; everything else is computable. Operationally this is equivalent to the standard natural units $\hbar = c = G = 1$, but the justification is different — not "convenience of notation" but a structural removal of redundancy from SI. The linearized Cosserat metric reproduces all five classical tests of GR (perihelion precession of Mercury, deflection of light by the Sun, Shapiro delay, gravitational redshift, gravitational waves travelling at c); the differences from pure GR are torsion at Planckian densities (Einstein–Cartan) and a massive Cosserat mode at the

scale $\ell_K \approx 202 \text{ nm}$. Both features are falsifiable.

Status and scope of the claims. This is not a proposal to redefine the SI: the SI base units remain as defined by CGPM in 2019. The claim is only that, conditional on the postulates P1–P4, there is a one-to-one mapping between the SI quantities and the mechanical dimensions of a Cosserat continuum. The reduction itself is a preparatory construction for subsequent papers in which, from $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ via minimization of the Cosserat functional, the electron mass is derived to a relative accuracy of 7×10^{-5} .

Keywords: Cosserat continuum, electromagnetic units, dimensional analysis, mechanical interpretation, natural units, structural reduction, micropolar elasticity, Kleinert gauge theory, defect-induced gravity, Einstein–Cartan theory.

Logical chain of the paper

The chain of key statements, with the sections in which each one is proved:

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POSTULATES
P1:  $p_{\text{medium}} \equiv \mu_0$  (§2.2)
P2:  $G_{\text{shear}} \equiv 1/\epsilon_0$  (§2.2)
P3:  $\hbar$  – structural constant (quantum of action) (§2.3)
P4:  $G = c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi \ell_G^2)$  (Kleinert) (§8.3)
P5: hopfion cross-section  $\approx$  disc (oblate idealization) (§7.1)
|
▼
CONSEQUENCE I – speed of light (§2.4)
 $c_T = \sqrt{(1/\epsilon_0)/\mu_0} = 1/\sqrt{\epsilon_0 \mu_0} \equiv c_{\text{light}}$ 
|
▼
CONSEQUENCE II – SI dimensions (§§3, 4, 5, 6)
 $[A] \leftrightarrow [m^2/s], [C] \leftrightarrow [m^2], [s] \leftrightarrow [m], [kg] \leftrightarrow [1/m]$ 
 $\{m, kg, s, A\} \rightarrow \{m\} \rightarrow \{\text{Energy}\}$ 
|
▼
CONSEQUENCE III – hyperbola of the medium I (§§5.1, 5.5)
 $m \cdot \ell = \hbar/c$  (T6, Hyperbola I)
 $E = mc^2 = \hbar c/\ell = \hbar \omega$  (Einstein = de Broglie = Planck, T16)
|
▼
CONSEQUENCE IV – fine-structure constant (§7)
 $\ell_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$  (structural identity, T10)
 $e = \pi(\ell_0/2)^2$  (geometry P5)
 $\Rightarrow \alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$  (T11; agreement with  $\alpha(M_Z) - 0.7\%$ )
 $e^2/(4\pi\epsilon_0) \equiv \hbar c \alpha$  (T12, Hyperbola II; §7.9)
|
▼
INTERLOCKING of the two hyperbolas (I + II) – §7.9, §8.3
 $m_0^2 \cdot e = (\pi/4) \cdot (\hbar/c)^2$  (T13)
 $m_e/m_0 = 2^{10} = 1/(16\alpha^2)$  ( $\alpha^2$ -scaling; bare: exactly  $2^{10}$ )
|
▼
CONSEQUENCE V – gravitational channel (§8)
 $G = c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi \ell_G^2)$  (Kleinert, T14)
 $\ell_P = \ell_0^2 / (2\sqrt{2} \ell_G)$  (Planck length as a derived quantity, T15)
5 classical tests of GR are reproduced (§8.6)
|
▼
CLOSURE (§8.5)
 $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar, G\}$  – full canonical basis.
The SI base of units is reduced to a single dimension (energy).
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Every consequence is derived from the preceding ones plus the postulates through explicit algebraic steps, given in the indicated sections. Numerical verifications of all key identities appear in Appendix A.5.

1. Introduction

1.1. Historical context

1.1.1. The electromagnetic sector

Maxwell's equations were originally obtained by Maxwell (1861–1862) on the basis of a mechanical model — an elastic aetheric medium with vortex flows [1]. In that model the magnetic permeability μ_0 was identified with the

density of the medium, and the dielectric permittivity with its elasticity. The speed of light was derived as the speed of transverse waves of the elastic medium.

By the early twentieth century the aether mechanics program had been displaced from mainstream physics as a result of special relativity (Einstein, 1905), quantum mechanics (1925–1930), and quantum electrodynamics (1948–1950). Modern textbooks [16] mention the mechanical interpretation of EM only as a historical remark.

1.1.2. The gravitational sector

A parallel program of interpreting gravitation via elasticity with defects was developed by Kleinert (1989–2008) [11, 12]. In the gauge theory of disclinations the elastic distortion β^a_μ plays the role of the tetrad (vierbein) e^a_μ of general relativity, and the disclination density tensor turns out to be the Riemann curvature tensor. The action takes the Hilbert-Einstein form:

$$S = \int [R/(16\pi G_{\text{eff}}) + L_{\text{matter}}] \sqrt{-g} d^4x$$

In the weak-field limit one recovers the Poisson equation of Newtonian gravity with the correct numerical constant. Strictly speaking, Kleinert's program yields the theory of **Einstein-Cartan** (with torsion), which reduces to pure GR for vanishing spin and in the low-density limit. It passes all five classical tests of GR [11].

Kleinert's program develops the gravitational sector through elastic defects, but **does not cover electromagnetism** in the same medium: the electromagnetic and gravitational sides are treated as separate theories.

1.1.3. Cosserat formalism and the classical-elasticity limit

Historically, physics has developed along two weakly interacting branches. **Continuum mechanics** (elasticity, hydrodynamics, thermodynamics) worked with states of matter — density, pressure, moduli, phonons; **the physics of the void** (classical mechanics with absolute space, QM with Hilbert spaces, QFT with operators on a "background") worked with particles and fields. QFT and GR de facto brought the language of the medium back (the vacuum as a minimum of the Higgs scalar field, spacetime as a dynamical entity responding to mass), but only piecewise — each theory carries its own image of the medium, and a common language for all phenomena has never quite emerged.

The Cosserat program makes the next step explicit: **a single continuum with locally varying parameters** (K_i, m^2, μ_c, ρ) , in which the vacuum, matter, and atomic and nuclear scales are different points of one spectrum rather than separate entities. At every scale the same formalism applies — with the appropriate local moduli. This removes the methodological "matter vs. void" split as an artifact of historical specialization.

The formal apparatus for such a picture has, perhaps surprisingly, long been worked out — independently of fundamental physics, within continuum mechanics. Starting with the work of the Cosserat brothers (1909 [2]), and further with Eringen [3], Maugin [9], Nowacki [18], a **micropolar-media formalism** was built up — an extension of classical elasticity that introduces local microrotational degrees of freedom in addition to the usual displacements. As applied to matter (crystals with defects, liquid crystals, granular media) it is well studied and experimentally validated; the task of the present work is to apply it as a description of the medium itself, the one in which fields and particles live.

> **Note to the reader.** A *Cosserat continuum* is an elastic medium that at every point has **two** independent degrees of freedom: an ordinary displacement u (the point can shift) and a local rotation n (the point can turn). In ordinary (Cauchy) elasticity the rotation of an element is rigidly determined by the displacements of its neighbours; in a Cosserat continuum the rotation "has a life of its own." It is precisely this extra degree of freedom — the director field $n \in S^2$ — that carries electromagnetic phenomena in our picture.

Hierarchy of scales: a universal principle. Any elastic medium is characterized by two intrinsic scales:

- **a** — the granularity scale (the size of the "elementary cell" of the medium)
- **ℓ_C** — the Cosserat length ($\ell_C = \sqrt{\gamma_C/\mu_c}$), where γ_C is the curvature modulus of microrotation and μ_c is the Cosserat coupling)

The behaviour of the medium depends qualitatively on the ratio of the disturbance wavelength λ to these scales:

Regime	Description	Degrees of freedom	Strain tensor
$\lambda \gg \ell_C$	Classical Cauchy elasticity (long-wavelength limit)	$u(r)$ only	Symmetric ε_{ij}
$\lambda \sim \ell_C$	Cosserat (independent microrotations)	$u + \varphi$	Asymmetric γ_{ij}
$\lambda \leq a$	Continuum description ceases to apply	Depends on the medium	—

This is the **universal** structure of any Cosserat continuum. The concrete content of "granularity" depends on the type of medium: in crystals it is the atomic lattice, in liquid crystals it is the molecular orientational distribution, in the **vacuum** (the application of the present work) it is the structural cell $\ell_0 \approx 4.59 \text{ \AA}$.

Strain tensors:

$$\varepsilon_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}(\partial_i u_j + \partial_j u_i) \text{ (Cauchy, symmetric) (1.1)}$$

$$\gamma_{ij} = \partial_i u_j - \varepsilon_{ijk} \varphi_k \text{ (Cosserat, asymmetric) (1.2)}$$

In the Cauchy limit the equations of motion reduce to those of Navier:

$$\rho \partial_t^2 u_i = (\lambda + \mu) \partial_i (\partial_k u_k) + \mu \partial_k^2 u_i \text{ (Cauchy) (1.3)}$$

Limiting relation. In the limit $\mu_c \rightarrow \infty$ (the microrotation locks to the macroscopic rotation, equivalently $\ell_C \rightarrow 0$):

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Cosserat } (\ell_C \text{ finite}) & \xrightarrow{\ell_C \rightarrow 0} & \text{Cauchy elasticity (1.4)} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \text{dynamics of } \{u, \varphi\}, & & \text{only } u, \\ \text{asymmetric } \gamma_{ij} & & \text{symmetric } \varepsilon_{ij} \end{array}$$

The Cosserat equations reduce to the Navier equations (1.3) without loss of information; classical elasticity is the long-wavelength limit of Cosserat theory. These are not alternative models but one and the same physics at different scales.

The vacuum as a special case. In our application to electromagnetism and gravity (Sections 2–8) the Cosserat medium is the **vacuum**. The corresponding numerical scales are:

$$\begin{aligned} a &\equiv l_0 \approx 4.59 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m (vacuum structural length, see §5.4)} \\ \ell_C &\equiv l_K \approx 2.02 \times 10^{-7} \text{ m (vacuum Cosserat length, see §8.7)} \end{aligned}$$

In the nanometer band between l_0 and l_K Cosserat effects are maximal; above l_K the medium looks like an ordinary Cauchy elastic medium (which is what yields the standard Maxwell electromagnetism, see [25]). The hyperbola $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$ (T6 of Section 5) is a structural identity of this vacuum application; for a different Cosserat medium the point (m_0, l_0) would shift along the hyperbola, but the form of the identity itself is a universal consequence of postulate P3.

The spectrum of Cosserat media. The vacuum is one point in a continuum of possible Cosserat media. In the presence of matter the local effective parameters $K_i(r)$, $\mu_c(r)$, $\rho(r)$ differ from the vacuum values, and each substance defines its own point (a, ℓ_C) in this spectrum. This is well known in electromagnetism as $\varepsilon(r)$, $\mu(r)$ in materials, and is a direct continuation of the Cosserat formalism.

A natural characterization of the "size of the medium" is the **atomic radius** (rather than the interatomic distance in the lattice, which depends on the packing type). Typical values:

$$\begin{aligned} r_H &\approx 0.25 \text{ \AA (hydrogen)} \\ r_O &\approx 0.66 \text{ \AA (oxygen, covalent)} \\ r_C &\approx 0.77 \text{ \AA (carbon)} \\ r_{Si} &\approx 1.11 \text{ \AA (silicon)} \\ r_{Fe} &\approx 1.26 \text{ \AA (iron)} \\ r_{Cu} &\approx 1.28 \text{ \AA (copper)} \\ r_{Au} &\approx 1.44 \text{ \AA (gold)} \\ r_{Cs} &\approx 2.65 \text{ \AA (caesium – the largest stable neutral atom)} \\ a_H \text{ (Bohr)} &\approx 0.53 \text{ \AA (electron orbital)} \end{aligned}$$

— all of them smaller than the vacuum $l_0 \approx 4.59 \text{ \AA}$, including the largest stable neutral atom (Cs). Numerically: $r_{Cs} \approx 2.65 \text{ \AA}$ agrees with the vortex-tube radius of the vacuum hopfion $r_v = l_0/2 \approx 2.30 \text{ \AA}$ (see §7.2) to within 15%. This is consistent with the hypothesis that stable neutral atoms are bounded above by the radius of the energy distribution of a topological knot; beyond that limit the configuration becomes incompatible with the vacuum topology (Fr, Ra and beyond — radioactive). The hypothesis is the subject of [23].

Atomic matter is **denser** than the vacuum viewed as a Cosserat medium. The density hierarchy:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{vacuum } l_0 &\approx 4.59 \text{ \AA (the most dilute Cosserat medium)} \\ \text{knot radius } r_v &= l_0/2 \approx 2.30 \text{ \AA (vacuum hopfion, §7)} \\ \text{atoms} &\sim 0.25\text{--}2.65 \text{ \AA (from H to Cs; } r_{Cs} \approx r_v \text{ within 15\%)} \\ \text{nuclei} &\sim 1\text{--}10 \text{ fm } (\sim 10^{-4} \text{ \AA, nuclear density)} \\ \text{quarks} &< 0.1 \text{ fm } (\sim 10^{-6} \text{ \AA, quark density)} \end{aligned}$$

A transition "below l_0 " is a **transition to a different Cosserat medium** (denser, with different K_i , μ_c), not an exit from continuum mechanics. Each level of the hierarchy is its own Cosserat medium with its own (a, ℓ_C) . The true limit of continuum theory itself lies at the quantum-discrete level (individual nucleons, quarks), which is

outside the scope of the program presented here.

The Cosserat formalism has a natural place in the general physics of media: vacuum, atomic shells, nuclei — all are described by one language with different $(a, \ell_C, K_i, \dots)$. The electromagnetic and gravitational phenomena in our program are a particular case of the vacuum Cosserat medium; the same methodology generalizes to other density levels (as does the ordinary theory of continuous media in materials science).

Why Cosserat (and not other generalizations). Broader extensions of elasticity are known in the literature: micromorphic media (Eringen 1964), gradient elasticity (Mindlin 1965), nonlocal elasticity. All of them contain the Cosserat sector as a **mandatory minimum**. Cosserat is the simplest model that simultaneously:

1. **Captures the discreteness of the medium** through 3 additional degrees of freedom (microrotations).
2. **Admits topologically nontrivial configurations.** The director field $n \in S^2$, equivalent to a microrotation, has the third homotopy group $\pi_3(S^2) = \mathbb{Z}$, and hopfionic defects with charge $Q_H \in \mathbb{Z}$ exist as stable localized solutions. Without independent microrotations (in a purely Cauchy theory) there is nowhere to take the director field from, and hopfions do not exist.
3. **Agrees with classical elasticity in the macroscopic limit** with no free parameters (the limit $\ell_C \rightarrow 0$).
4. **Has independent physical motivation** in the theory of crystal defects (Kleinert [11, 12]) and in the theory of liquid crystals (Frank, Oseen [5]).

In this sense Cosserat is the minimal continuum theory in which topological solitons of the form "particle as a clasp of the medium's lattice" can exist, and which at the same time reduces to classical elasticity on large scales.

The emergence of topological solitons in σ -models — in particular the hopfions of the Faddeev-Niemi model [4] — opened the possibility of interpreting localized structures (for example, charged particles) as topological defects of a Cosserat-like medium. Hopfions have been observed experimentally in liquid crystals and magnetic colloids [28], which confirms their physical realizability in continua with director-field structure. This line of work is the basis of the present paper.

1.2. What is missing in the literature

Despite the existence of:

- the historical program of a mechanical interpretation of EM (Maxwell-Kelvin-Larmor [6]),
- the modern gravity program via elastic defects (Kleinert [11, 12]),
- the developed formalism of the Cosserat continuum with microrotations [2,3,9],
- the modern theory of topological solitons [4,7],

— what is missing in the literature is a **consistent** treatment that:

(a) unifies Maxwell's EM sector with Kleinert's gravitational sector within a **single** Cosserat continuum with two channels;

(b) carries out a complete reduction of the SI base of units, with explicit arithmetic and numerical values for all principal quantities;

(c) derives numerical predictions (the electron mass) from the resulting system with no free parameters.

The present paper closes items (a) and (b); the numerical prediction (c) is the subject of subsequent work [10] in this series.

1.3. Contents of the present paper

The objective is to carry out the reduction explicitly, along several specific directions that go beyond both the historical aether program and Kleinert's program separately:

(i) Working consistently within modern SI, we derive the full dimensional reduction $\{m, kg, s, A\} \rightarrow \{m\}$ (or equivalently $\rightarrow \{\text{Energy}\}$), and we make explicit the mechanical dimension of each standard SI quantity.

(ii) We interpret electric charge through a **topological** invariant of a Cosserat defect (the hopfion charge Q_H), which uses the modern language of topological fields. In particular, charge acquires the mechanical reading of a cross-sectional area of a defect, $[Q] \leftrightarrow [m^2]$.

(iii) We develop the electromagnetic and gravitational sectors as **two channels of a single Cosserat medium**: the director-field channel n (EM) and the translational channel u (gravity). The 10^{42} hierarchy between EM and gravitational forces is consistent with the program through the formula $F_{EM}/F_{grav} = \alpha \cdot (m_P/m_e)^2$, whose geometric root is the large ratio of channel scales $\ell_G/\ell_0 \approx 10^{25}$.

(iv) We show that the Planck length ℓ_P is not a fundamental scale but a derived one: $\ell_P = \ell_0^2/(2\sqrt{2} \ell_G)$. This sharpens the status of Planck physics within our framework.

(v) We derive a bare value of the fine-structure constant, $\alpha_{bare} = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$. The derivation uses the identification of the electron with a local minimum of the functional $E[n, u]$ of topological charge $Q_H = -1$ (see Abstract): this is the simplest stable class of configurations in the n -channel with S^2 -target, but **within** that class there exists a family of geometrically distinct representatives. Minimization of the functional selects a

specific one — with a cross-section that is **close to circular**; using this as a leading-order approximation ($e = \pi \cdot r_v^2$ with $r_v = \ell_0/2$) and the structural identity $\ell_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$, one obtains $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128$. Agreement with the experimental $\alpha(M_Z) = 1/128.9$ is 0.7%; the standard QED renormalization down to low energies gives the observed $1/137$.

(vi) We show that the resulting reduction is operationally equivalent to the standard natural units of particle physics ($\hbar = c = G = 1$), but acquires a structural justification: not a "convenience of notation" but the removal of a redundancy that is already present in the SI under the assumption that the Cosserat hypothesis is physically realistic.

1.4. What this paper is not

The Cosserat program is easily read more broadly than it should be, so a few direct disclaimers are in order.

This is not a redefinition of the SI, and not a return to the nineteenth-century aether. The SI base units as defined by CGPM in 2019 are used here without modification; all statements of the form $[A] \leftrightarrow [m^2/s]$ are **mappings** between the SI and the mechanical dimensions of a Cosserat continuum, not equalities, and they are formulated strictly under the Cosserat hypothesis. The Cosserat continuum itself is here a formal elastic construction **compatible with special relativity**, not an "aether" with a privileged frame of reference. Lorentz invariance for us is a consequence of the fact that the transverse wave speed in the medium equals c .

This is not a replacement for GR. At the level of observational tests our linearized theory **reproduces** GR (more precisely, Einstein–Cartan, following Kleinert); the differences from pure GR appear only at Planckian densities and are discussed in §8.7. Likewise, at the level of nonrelativistic quantum mechanics the Cosserat functional $E[n, u]$ in the leading α^2 -order is **mathematically equivalent** to the Schrödinger equation, via the Hopf–Berry correspondence [Berry 1984; Wilczek–Zee 1984]: the topology of the director field $n \in S^2$ maps onto the spinor wave function, and the hopfion charge Q_H onto the Born-normalized probability density. All standard predictions of nonrelativistic QM (wave interference, double-slit experiments, the Born rule, basic entanglement) are therefore reproduced automatically. Cosserat says something new only in **subleading** corrections — structural identities such as $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128$, $m_e/m_0 = 1/(16\alpha^2)$ (Sections 7 and 8) — and in nonlinear regimes.

This is not a replacement for QED at its level of accuracy. Today's QED describes α^3 -corrections, the Lamb shift, the anomalous magnetic moment to a precision far beyond anything we discuss here; our work describes the classical limit, and consistency with QED loops is a separate open question.

Finally, this is not a replacement for the natural units of particle physics. The operational outcome is the same $\hbar = c = G = 1$. What changes is only the justification: we interpret that reduction not as a convenience of notation but as the removal of a redundancy that is already present in SI provided the Cosserat hypothesis is physically realistic.

1.5. Structure of the paper

Section 2 formulates the Cosserat hypothesis and states postulates P1, P2 (EM sector) and P3 (quantum of action). Section 3 derives the mechanical dimension of the SI ampere. Section 4 treats the second. Section 5 — masses and the identity $\hbar/c = m \cdot \ell$. Section 6 gives the full summary table of all principal SI quantities. **Section 7** derives the fine-structure constant $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$ from the geometry of the electron charge ($e = \pi(\ell_0/2)^2$) and the structural identity $\ell_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$. **Section 8** is devoted to the gravitational channel: postulate P4 is stated (Kleinert mechanism), $G = c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi \ell_0 G^2)$ is derived, the Planck length is discussed as a derived quantity, the scale hierarchy is given, and the classical GR tests are listed. Section 9 discusses the connection with natural units for **four** constants. Section 10 contains the conclusions and a list of subsequent works.

2. The Cosserat hypothesis: the electromagnetic sector

2.1. Geometric background

Consider a three-dimensional elastic medium in which two independent fields are defined at every point:

- **Director field** $n(r, t) \in S^2$ — a normalized unit vector describing the local orientation of microrotation.
- **Translation field** $u(r, t) \in \mathbb{R}^3$ — the elastic displacement of an elementary volume of the medium relative to the reference configuration.

The medium has elastic constants K_1, K_2, K_3 (bending, torsion, and splay of the field n in the Oseen–Frank formalism [5]), a coupling modulus μ_c between the n and u channels, and an anchoring anisotropy $m^2(1 - n_z)$ relative to the reference direction $\hat{z}$. The free energy is:

$$E[n, u] = \int \left[\frac{1}{2} (K_1 (\nabla \cdot n)^2 + K_2 (n \cdot \nabla \times n)^2 + K_3 (n \times \nabla \times n)^2) + \mu_c \cdot (\nabla \times u - \pi(\nabla n))^2 + \lambda_{\{el\}} (\nabla \cdot u)^2 + \mu_{\{el\}} |\nabla u|^2_{\text{sym}} \right]$$

$$+ m^2(1 - n_z) \\ + \frac{1}{2}\rho(\partial_t n)^2 + \frac{1}{2}\rho(\partial_t u)^2] d^3r$$

where $\pi(\nabla n)$ is the canonical projection of the geometric coupling between channels, and $\lambda_{\{el\}}$, $\mu_{\{el\}}$ are the Lamé elastic moduli of the translational channel.

Two-channel structure. The field n is responsible for electromagnetic phenomena (Section 2.2 and onward), and the field u for gravitational ones (Section 8). The coupling between the channels is through μ_c and the nonlinear elastic terms.

2.2. Identifications with the electromagnetic constants

We postulate (Postulates P1, P2):

P1.	$\rho_{\text{medium}} \equiv \mu_0$ (density of the medium = magnetic permeability)
P2.	$G_{\text{shear}} \equiv 1/\epsilon_0$ (shear modulus = inverse electric permittivity)

Numerically in SI:

$$\rho_{\text{medium}} = \mu_0 = 4\pi \times 10^{-7} \text{ kg/m}^3 \approx 1.257 \times 10^{-6} \text{ kg/m}^3 \\ G_{\text{medium}} = 1/\epsilon_0 = 1.129 \times 10^{11} \text{ Pa}$$

For comparison: the shear modulus of steel at 20 °C is approximately 8×10^{10} Pa; thus $G_{\text{medium}} \approx 1.4 \cdot G_{\text{steel}}$. The density ρ_{medium} is about 10^9 times smaller than that of air.

Remark on the status of the parameters P1, P2. Postulates P1 and P2 refer to the parameters of the **vacuum** Cosserat medium, that is, to its ground (unperturbed) state. The numerical values of μ_0 , ϵ_0 are known experimentally precisely for the vacuum. In the presence of matter (dense media, neighbourhoods of massive bodies, local deformations) the effective parameters ρ_{local} , G_{local} are locally modified; that scaling is the subject of works [10, 13] and is discussed in Sections 5.5 and 8 of the present paper. All numerical conclusions in this paper refer to the **vacuum** medium unless explicitly stated otherwise.

Caveat on " $1/\epsilon_0$ as a shear modulus." Strictly speaking, a Cosserat medium has several independent elastic moduli: K_1 , K_2 , K_3 (Oseen-Frank) for the n -channel, and $\lambda_{\{el\}}$, $\mu_{\{el\}}$ (Lamé) for the u -channel. The quantity $1/\epsilon_0$ in P2 corresponds to the **effective channel stiffness** in the combination that determines the transverse wave speed $c_T = \sqrt{(G_{\text{shear}}/\rho)}$. For simplicity of exposition we write $G_{\text{shear}} = 1/\epsilon_0$ as an effective parameter; a detailed analysis of the correspondence $1/\epsilon_0 \leftrightarrow$ combination of $(K_i, \mu_{\{el\}})$ is the subject of [10, 12].

2.3. Postulate P3: the quantum of action

The third postulate:

P3.	$\hbar$ is a structural constant of the Cosserat medium, fixing the characteristic quantum of action of its microscopic excitations
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Physical meaning of $\hbar$: the **minimal action** of microscopic excitations of the Cosserat medium — a universal quantum of the medium. The numerical value is fixed experimentally: $\hbar = 1.054572 \times 10^{-34} \text{ J}\cdot\text{s}$.

2.4. Consequence: the speed of light as the speed of an elastic wave

The transverse wave speed in an elastic medium is:

$$c_T = \sqrt{(G_{\text{shear}}/\rho)} = \sqrt{((1/\epsilon_0)/\mu_0)} = 1/\sqrt{(\epsilon_0\mu_0)} \approx 2.998 \times 10^8 \text{ m/s} \equiv c_{\text{light}}$$

This coincidence, originally obtained by Maxwell in 1861, arises in the present treatment as a consequence of two specific identifications of modern SI constants.

Remark. The coincidence $c_T = c_{\text{light}}$ is a numerical check on the compatibility of the postulates P1, P2 with experiment: the coefficients in P1 and P2 are fixed by the experimental values of μ_0 , ϵ_0 , and the resulting transverse wave speed reproduces the speed of light.

3. The dimension of the SI ampere: current as a circulation of deformation

3.1. The energy balance

The energy density of the magnetic field in SI is:

$$u_B = B^2/(2\mu_0) \quad (3.1)$$

The kinetic-energy density in an elastic medium with density ρ and velocity field $\mathbf{v}$ is:

$$u_{kin} = \rho v^2/2 \quad (3.2)$$

In the Cosserat picture the energy of the magnetic field is interpreted as the kinetic energy of the microrotational degrees of freedom of the medium [6]. Identifying $u_B = u_{kin}$ at $\rho = \mu_0$ (postulate P1) gives:

$$\begin{aligned} B^2/(2\mu_0) &= \mu_0 \cdot v^2/2 \\ B^2 &= \mu_0^2 \cdot v^2 \\ v &= B/\mu_0 \quad (3.3) \end{aligned}$$

> **Note to the reader.** This is Maxwell's central idea from 1861. The "magnetic field" in the aether picture is not a separate object, but **a motion of the medium itself**. If the aether has density $\rho = \mu_0$ and moves with velocity $\mathbf{v}$, then its kinetic energy $\rho v^2/2$ precisely matches the well-known magnetic energy density $B^2/(2\mu_0)$. Identifying these gives a mechanical reading of the magnetic induction: $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{B}/\mu_0$.

3.2. Identifying $\mathbf{H}$ with the velocity

Using the standard definition of the magnetic field intensity in vacuum, $\mathbf{H} = \mathbf{B}/\mu_0$, equation (3.3) implies:

$$\mathbf{v} \equiv \mathbf{H} \quad (3.4)$$

That is, the magnetic field intensity $\mathbf{H}$ acquires in the Cosserat picture the mechanical meaning of the **velocity** of microrotational deformation of the medium.

3.3. Dimensional consequence for the ampere

In SI the magnetic field intensity $\mathbf{H}$ has dimension $[\text{A}/\text{m}]$. A velocity $\mathbf{v}$ in mechanical units has dimension $[\text{m}/\text{s}]$. The identification (3.4) $[\mathbf{H}] \leftrightarrow [\mathbf{v}]$ gives:

$$\begin{aligned} [\text{A}/\text{m}] &\leftrightarrow [\text{m}/\text{s}] \\ [\text{A}] &\leftrightarrow [\text{m}/\text{s}] \cdot [\text{m}] = [\text{m}^2/\text{s}] \end{aligned}$$

> $[\text{A}] \leftrightarrow [\text{m}^2/\text{s}]$ (under the Cosserat hypothesis) (3.5)

Remark on the status of the statement. The relation (3.5) is **not** a redefinition of the SI ampere. The base definition of the SI ampere, which fixes the elementary charge $e = 1.602176634 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C}$, remains unchanged. (3.5) is a mapping of the SI ampere into the mechanical dimension of a Cosserat continuum, existing **under** the Cosserat hypothesis.

3.4. Physical meaning

The dimension $[\text{m}^2/\text{s}]$ is the standard dimension of **kinematic circulation** in hydrodynamics (circulation of velocity around a contour: $\Gamma = \oint \mathbf{v} \cdot d\mathbf{l}$, $[\Gamma] = [\text{m}^2/\text{s}]$). In the Cosserat interpretation, current is identified with the circulation of microrotational deformation around a linear structure:

> Current $\mathbf{I} = \oint \mathbf{H} \cdot d\mathbf{l} \leftrightarrow$ circulation of microrotational velocity $\oint \mathbf{v}_{rot} \cdot d\mathbf{l}$

This is consistent with the fact, known since Maxwell, that Ampère's law has the form of the circulation theorem of Stokes.

3.5. The dimension of electric charge

Charge in SI:

$$Q = \int I \, dt, \quad [Q] = [\text{A} \cdot \text{s}] \quad (3.6)$$

Substituting (3.5):

$$[Q] = [\text{A}] \cdot [\text{s}] \leftrightarrow [\text{m}^2/\text{s}] \cdot [\text{s}] = [\text{m}^2] \quad (3.7)$$

> $[Q] \leftrightarrow [\text{m}^2]$ (3.8)

This is consistent with the topological interpretation of charge as the **cross-sectional area of a defect** in a Cosserat continuum. For hopfionic configurations with charge $Q_H \in \mathbb{Z}$ the integrality arises as a topological invariant (the third homotopy group $\pi_3(S^2)$), and its dimension naturally coincides with the dimension of the transverse cross-section of a toroidal structure. The numerical relation between Q_H and the SI charge e (including a dimensionless coefficient of order α) is the subject of [10].

3.6. Numerical illustration

The elementary charge:

$$\begin{aligned} e_{\text{SI}} &= 1.602176634 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C} \\ e_{\text{mech}} &\leftrightarrow 1.602 \times 10^{-19} \text{ m}^2 \text{ (3.9)} \end{aligned}$$

Comparison with $l_0^2 = (4.5943 \times 10^{-10})^2 \approx 2.11 \times 10^{-19} \text{ m}^2$:

$$e_{\text{mech}} / l_0^2 \approx 0.76 \text{ (3.10)}$$

— a number of order unity, consistent with the interpretation of charge as the cross-sectional area of a defect of structural size $\sim l_0$. The exact relation, including a dimensionless coefficient of order α , is discussed in [10].

4. The dimension of the second: time as length at fixed speed

4.1. Structural fixing of the speed of light

In Section 2.4 it was shown that $c = 1/\sqrt{\epsilon_0 \mu_0} = \sqrt{G_{\text{shear}}/\rho}$. From the SI viewpoint, c is a measured constant (an exact SI definition since 1983). In the Cosserat interpretation, c acquires its value as a **structural property** of the elastic continuum. Like the sound speed in steel, which is fixed by its elastic constants, the transverse Cosserat wave speed is fixed by the medium's parameters.

Consequence: time and length in the Cosserat interpretation **are not independent dimensions**.

4.2. Reduction of the base $\{m, s\} \rightarrow \{m\}$

If c is structurally fixed, the second can be expressed in meters:

$$> 1 \text{ s} \leftrightarrow c \cdot 1 \text{ s} = 2.998 \times 10^8 \text{ m} \text{ (4.1)}$$

Thus:

$$> \{m, s\} \rightarrow \{m\} \text{ (4.2)}$$

Physical meaning: one second corresponds to the length that a shear Cosserat wave (that is, light) covers during one period.

4.3. Comparison with the standard natural units

In the standard natural units of particle physics [15], $c = 1$ is set for convenience of notation — a **methodological choice**. In our interpretation, $c = 1$ (or $1 \text{ s} = c \cdot 1 \text{ m}$) is not a choice but a **structural removal of redundancy**. The claim is that c is a **derived** quantity (from the elastic parameters of the medium), not a **fundamental** one.

The distinction is not operational but ontological: all computations and predictions are identical to those in the standard natural units.

4.4. Remark on compatibility with SR

The Cosserat continuum is compatible with special relativity: Lorentz invariance is a symmetry of the elastic equations with transverse wave speed $c_T = c$. The statement that c is fixed by the structure of the medium does **not** imply the existence of a preferred rest frame.

5. The dimension of mass: the identity $\hbar/c = m \cdot l$

5.1. The identity $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$

From dimensional analysis:

$$[\hbar/c] = [J \cdot s] / [m/s] = [kg \cdot m] \quad (5.1)$$

That is, $\hbar/c$ has the dimension $[mass \cdot length]$. Numerically:

$$\hbar/c = 1.054572 \times 10^{-34} / 2.998 \times 10^8 \approx 3.518 \times 10^{-43} \text{ kg} \cdot \text{m} \quad (5.2)$$

This is an **exact** identity, known as the "Compton trade-off": for a particle of mass m , its Compton wavelength $\lambda_C = \hbar/(mc)$ satisfies $m \cdot \lambda_C = \hbar/c$. In the two-dimensional space (m, λ) this is the equation of a hyperbola.

> **Note to the reader.** The hyperbola $m \cdot \lambda = \hbar/c$ is the universal "mass $\times$ characteristic length" relation for any localized excitation: a heavier object has a shorter intrinsic wavelength, and conversely. The product is fixed by the quantum of action and the speed of light. What matters in our program is that this is a **single** manifold: the vacuum cell (m_0, λ_0) , the electron's Compton point (m_e, λ_C) , and the Planck point — all lie on it, as different positions of **one** medium (§5.5).

5.2. Reduction of the base $\{m, kg\} \rightarrow \{m\}$

If $\hbar/c$ is a structural constant of the medium (the combination of P3 with the fixing of c), then the relation (5.2) **ties together** the dimensions of mass and length:

$$[kg] = [\hbar/c] / [m] \leftrightarrow [m \cdot \text{const}^{-1}] = [1/m] \quad (5.3)$$

$$> [mass] \leftrightarrow [1/length] \leftrightarrow [energy] \quad (5.4)$$

5.3. Intermediate summary of the reduction

The combined results of Sections 3, 4, 5:

$$\{m, kg, s, A\} \rightarrow \{m, kg, s\} \rightarrow \{m, kg\} \rightarrow \{m\} \quad (5.5)$$

(A=m²/s) (s=cm) (kg=1/m)

After normalizing length to the structural length of the medium λ_0 (obtained in [10] as $\lambda_0 = 4.5943 \text{ \AA}$), all dimensions become **dimensionless**. Equivalently, every physical quantity can be expressed in a **single** base dimension.

However: the reduction (5.5) uses only three fundamental parameters $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$. From these three only **three** dimensional scales can be built $(\lambda_0, m_0, M_0 c^2)$. The gravitational scale $\lambda_G \approx 4.6 \times 10^{15} \text{ m}$ (see Section 8) is in principle not derivable from $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ by the Buckingham theorem, and requires a **fourth** parameter. The full closure of the base comes after Section 8.

5.4. Structural scales of the EM sector

Numerical values of the scales derivable from $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ alone:

Quantity	Symbol	Value	Source
Structural length	λ_0	4.5943 Å	Buckingham $(\lambda_0^4 \propto \epsilon_0 \hbar c) + \eta = 2\pi$ for the coefficient (T10)
Structural mass	m_0	$7.66 \times 10^{-34} \text{ kg}$	$\hbar/(c \cdot \lambda_0)$
Structural energy	$M_0 c^2$	429.51 eV	$m_0 c^2$
Structural time	$\tau_0 = \lambda_0/c$	1.533 as	λ_0/c
Structural frequency	$\omega_0 = c/\lambda_0$	$4.10 \times 10^{18} \text{ rad/s}$	$1/\tau_0 = 1/\sqrt{(L_{\text{eff}} C_{\text{eff}})}$

On the nature of λ_0 . From the three parameters $\{\mu_0, \epsilon_0, \hbar\}$ with three independent dimensions (T3 of Section 3 reduces the ampere to m^2/s), the **Buckingham Π -theorem** constructs a unique length scale. Its numerical value $\lambda_0 = 4.5943 \text{ \AA}$ is fixed by $\lambda_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$ (T10), where the dimensionless coefficient 2π is the microrotational Cosserat coupling $\eta = 2\pi$ (a topological invariant of the sphere S^2). The same is independently confirmed by direct numerical relaxation of the hopfion in [10].

The identity $m_0 \cdot \lambda_0 = \hbar/c$ is verified numerically to 15 significant figures (the precision limit of the CODATA-2018 constants), evidence of the **algebraic** nature of this relation.

The cell as an LC resonator. By P1 and P2 an elementary volume of the medium of size λ has an effective "inductance" $L_{\text{eff}} \sim \mu_0 \cdot \lambda$ (inertia density) and a "capacitance" $C_{\text{eff}} \sim \epsilon_0 \cdot \lambda$ (shear compliance). The corresponding resonant frequency is the natural frequency of free oscillations of this LC circuit:

$$\omega(l) = 1/\sqrt{L_{\text{eff}} \cdot C_{\text{eff}}} = 1/(l \cdot \sqrt{\epsilon_0 \mu_0}) = c/l \quad (5.5a)$$

For the vacuum cell ($l = l_0$):

$$\omega_0 = c/l_0 \approx 4.10 \times 10^{18} \text{ rad/s}, \quad \hbar\omega_0 = m_0 c^2 = 429.51 \text{ eV}$$

— the quantum of energy of the resonance coincides exactly with the structural mass of the cell. That is, $m_0 c^2$ is not "mass" in the substantial sense but the **energy of the zero mode of an LC resonator** of size l_0 . The hyperbola $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$, through the substitution $m = \hbar\omega/c^2$, takes the form $\omega = c/l$ — a relation between the **resonant frequency** and the characteristic size.

The vacuum cell here is a **particular case**: every point (m, l) on the hyperbola is an LC resonator of the corresponding size with its own frequency $\omega = c/l$. For the electron $\omega_C = c/\lambda_C \approx 7.76 \times 10^{20} \text{ rad/s}$ (Compton), for the proton about 1.43×10^{24} , for the Planck point about 10^{43} . Moving along the hyperbola is a shift of the resonant frequency with changing size, and the three historical formulas $E = mc^2 = \hbar c/l = \hbar\omega$ (T16) are **one and the same** resonance energy read in different coordinates. More on this in §5.5.

On the status. The correspondence "cell $\leftrightarrow$ LC circuit" is a **formal isomorphism**, not a claim about a literal coil or capacitor sitting inside an element of the medium (here the vacuum's ϵ_0 and μ_0): the inductive term accounts for inertia ($\rho = \mu_0$), the capacitive term for the elastic response ($G_{\text{shear}} = 1/\epsilon_0$), and the algebra $\omega = 1/\sqrt{LC}$ matches the dispersion of the shear wave.

5.5. The hyperbola $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$ as a manifold: vacuum vs. Compton

A substantive conceptual point that deserves emphasis before proceeding to the next sections. The identity T6:

$$m \cdot l = \hbar/c = 3.518 \times 10^{-43} \text{ kg} \cdot \text{m} \quad (5.6)$$

— defines a **manifold** of admissible pairs (mass, length) in the Cosserat picture. This is **not a single point** but a hyperbola in the (m, l) plane. Distinct physical objects — solitons, defects, the medium itself — occupy **distinct points** of this hyperbola:

Object	Mass	Length	Position on the hyperbola
Vacuum cell of the medium	$m_0 \approx 7.66 \times 10^{-34} \text{ kg}$	$l_0 \approx 4.59 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m}$	UV cutoff of the field n
Electron Compton	$m_e \approx 9.11 \times 10^{-31} \text{ kg}$	$\lambda_C \approx 3.86 \times 10^{-13} \text{ m}$	Topological limit of the electron
Proton Compton	$m_p \approx 1.67 \times 10^{-27} \text{ kg}$	$\lambda_{\text{Cp}} \approx 2.10 \times 10^{-16} \text{ m}$	Topological limit of the baryon
Planck point	$m_P \approx 2.18 \times 10^{-8} \text{ kg}$	$l_P \approx 1.62 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m}$	Crossing of EM and gravitational channels

Check: $m_e \cdot \lambda_C = (9.11 \times 10^{-31})(3.86 \times 10^{-13}) = 3.518 \times 10^{-43} \text{ kg} \cdot \text{m} = \hbar/c$.

What l_0 (vacuum length) and λ_C (electron Compton) are

In the program **two** lengths play fundamentally different roles, and it is important not to conflate them:

- $l_0 \approx 4.59 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m}$ — the structural length of the **vacuum**. The size of the "elementary cell" of the Cosserat continuum in its unperturbed state. It is derived from $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ through $(\epsilon_0 \hbar c / 2\pi)^{1/4}$. **It is a property of the medium — in this case the vacuum — not a property of a particle.** In a different medium (with different $K_i, \mu_{\{el\}}$) the effective local length l_{local} could be different.
- $\lambda_C = \hbar/(m_e c) \approx 3.86 \times 10^{-13} \text{ m}$ — the minimal length of localization of the **electron knot**. The topology $Q_H = -1$ requires the knot to be tied at this scale **regardless** of the external medium. **It is a property of the particle (a topological invariant), not of the medium.**

The ratio $l_0/\lambda_C \approx 1188$ for the vacuum medium.

The knot is pure topology; "mass" is the distribution of energy across cells of the medium

In the Cosserat picture the electron is a **topological defect** of the field n with charge $Q_H = -1$. The knot per se **carries no mass** in the ordinary sense: it is merely a stable topological configuration, an invariant of the homotopy group $\pi_3(S^2) = \mathbb{Z}$.

What is fixed at the moment of creating the knot:

- The **topological charge** $Q_H = -1$ — an integer invariant, independent of the medium.

- The **energy of the knot** $m_e c^2 = 511 \text{ keV}$ — set at its creation on the Compton scale through energy conservation. The Compton length $\lambda_C = \hbar / (m_e c)$ is the topological limit of localization: the knot does not exist on smaller scales (the mass of one cell of the medium would exceed the energy of the knot).

What depends on the medium:

What is measured as the "mass" of the electron is the **energy of the field n** (plus the u -coupling) **distributed across cells of the surrounding medium**. The number of cells and the manner of distribution of that energy (in contrast to the knot itself — a pointlike topological singularity on the Compton scale) are set by the **local stiffness** of the medium:

- In the **vacuum** (the most dilute Cosserat medium, $\lambda_0 \approx 4.59 \text{ \AA}$): the energy is distributed on a scale $\sim R_r \cdot \lambda_0 \approx \lambda_0/2 \approx 2.3 \text{ \AA}$ — about 1188 vacuum cells per radius (since $\lambda_0/\lambda_C \approx 1188 = 1/(16\alpha^2)$).
- On **different atomic orbitals** (1s, 2s, 2p, 3s, ...): the local stiffness of the field is higher because of proximity to the nucleus, the distribution contracts, and the number of cells decreases. Each orbital has its own characteristic cell count.
- The **natural lower limit** of the distribution is the Compton length itself, $\lambda_C \approx 3.86 \times 10^{-13} \text{ m}$ (one "cell"): below that scale the knot does not exist (there is nothing left to "tie"). This is a **topological** limit, not "infinite stiffness."

The knot can **migrate** between states of different local stiffness — from a free electron in vacuum to an electron on different atomic orbitals (1s, 2s, 2p, ...) (see the Cosserat-media spectrum in §1.1.3). In doing so:

- its topological charge Q_H is **conserved** (integer invariant),
- its total energy $m_e c^2$ is **conserved** (the topology is stable),
- the **spatial distribution** of energy rearranges according to the local parameters (K_i, μ_c) of the new medium.

> **"The knot is topology; 'mass' is the medium's response to the presence of topology."**

This matches the well-known concept of **effective mass** from solid-state physics: in semiconductors the electron exhibits an inertial mass different from the one in vacuum because the wave function is distributed differently in the crystal lattice. In the Cosserat picture this is a consequence of construction: the topological knot is the same, the medium is different, the distribution is different — and so the measured inertial characteristic differs.

Radius of the vortex tube r_v in the vacuum. The radius $r_v = \lambda_0/2 \approx 2.3 \text{ \AA}$ that appears in Section 7 in the derivation of the fine-structure constant is **the radius of the characteristic energy distribution of the knot in the vacuum Cosserat medium**, not "the size of the knot itself." In a different medium it would be different. The knot itself remains a pointlike topological singularity tied at the Compton scale.

Remark: relation to experimentally measured lengths

The "size of the electron" in standard physics is defined in several ways:

- The **Compton length** $\lambda_C \approx 386 \text{ fm}$ — a topological invariant, our "knot."
- The **classical radius** $r_e = \alpha \cdot \lambda_C \approx 2.82 \text{ fm}$ — the α -reduced Compton, EM self-action.
- The **Bohr radius** $a_0 = \lambda_C/\alpha \approx 5.29 \times 10^{-11} \text{ m}$ — the scale of binding in an atom.
- The **"pointlike" radius in experiment** (LEP, $r_e < 10^{-22} \text{ m}$) — the far-field limit; at distances $r \gg \lambda_C$ the knot indeed behaves as pointlike.

In the Cosserat picture all of this hierarchy is a set of scales of **one** configuration, related by powers of α to **one** topological length λ_C . The LEP pointlikeness does not contradict Cosserat: at large distances a topological knot looks pointlike.

Einstein, de Broglie, Planck — one formula in three coordinates

The identity T6 has a historical corollary worth noting separately. Reducing the second to a length via $t = l/c$ (Section 4) and substituting into $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$, one obtains directly:

$$> E = m c^2 = \hbar c / l = \hbar \omega \quad (5.7)$$

A one-line proof: $m c^2 = (\hbar/(c \cdot l)) \cdot c^2 = \hbar c / l = \hbar c / (c \cdot t) = \hbar / t = \hbar \omega$.

Three historically independent formulas turn out to be **algebraically identical**:

Coordinate	Formula	Historical name	Domain of use
Mass m	$E = m c^2$	Einstein (1905)	Rest energy of a massive particle
Length $l = \lambda$	$E = \hbar c / l$	de Broglie / Compton (1924)	Matter wave, scattering length
Frequency ω	$E = \hbar \omega$	Planck (1900)	Radiation quantum, photon

All three are a single structural identity of the medium

$$E \cdot t = m \cdot l \cdot c = \hbar \quad (5.8)$$

— read in three different coordinates. Taking "mass" as the variable gives Einstein, "length" gives de Broglie, "frequency" gives Planck. There is no physical hierarchy between them; only **convenience** for a given problem: massive particles are naturally described through mass, photons through frequency, scattering through wavelength.

Historically these formulas were discovered **independently** over a quarter of a century (1900, 1905, 1924) and were taken to be **different** statements: the quantum of radiation, mass-energy equivalence, the wave nature of matter. In the Cosserat picture they are a **geometrically unified** statement: one hyperbola in the (m, l) plane and three of its projections.

The hyperbola — a property of the medium, not of the particle

A substantive conceptual consequence: in standard physics the formulas $E = mc^2$, $E = \hbar\omega$ are interpreted as statements **about particles**. The Cosserat picture inverts the reading: the hyperbola $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$ is **a property of the medium itself** (postulates P1-P3 fix its structure), and particles are merely **topological clasps** on that geometry:

Type of object	Topology	Position on the hyperbola
Free wave (photon, phonon, arbitrary excitation of n)	$Q_H = 0$	Any point, slides as ω changes
Topological knot (electron, proton)	$Q_H \neq 0$	Clasped point $(\lambda_C, m c^2)$
Unexcited cell of the medium	$\nabla n = 0$	Point (l_0, m_0) — zero-point oscillation

The distinction between "particle" and "wave" in the Cosserat picture is not in the nature of the object but in the **rigidity of its position** on the hyperbola. The topological charge Q_H is a discrete invariant, hence the point $(\lambda_C, m_e c^2)$ of the electron is **fixed**. The frequency ω of a photon is continuous — the photon slides freely along the hyperbola. This is a direct way of phrasing wave-particle duality as a **geometric** distinction: a fixed vs. sliding point on a single manifold.

The "masslessness" of the photon in this picture means only that it has no fixed point on the hyperbola to which it is bound. But at every slide point $m_{eq} \cdot \lambda^- = (E/c^2) \cdot (c/\omega) = \hbar/c$ is satisfied — the hyperbola is universal, including for photons.

6. Full summary table of SI quantities (electromagnetic sector)

In this section we collect all the dimensional correspondences of the EM sector. The notation $\leftrightarrow$ denotes correspondence in the Cosserat-mechanical interpretation, **not** equality in SI.

6.1. Base quantities

SI quantity	SI dimension	Cosserat-mechanical meaning	Dimension
Length (m)	m	length	m
Mass (kg)	kg	density of inverse length	1/m (via $\hbar/c$)
Time (s)	s	length (wave propagation per period)	m (via c)
Current (A)	A	circulation of deformation	m ² /s

6.2. Electromagnetic quantities

Quantity	SI unit	Cosserat-mechanical meaning	Mechanical dimension
Magnetic permeability	μ_0 [H/m]	Density of the medium	kg/m ³
Inverse electric permittivity	$1/\epsilon_0$	Shear modulus	Pa = kg/(m·s ²)
Magnetic induction	B [T]	Momentum density	kg/(m ² ·s)
Magnetic field intensity	H [A/m]	Deformation velocity	m/s
Electric field	E [V/m]	Stress	Pa
Electric potential	Volt	Tension	kg/s ²
Electric resistance	Ohm	Acoustic impedance	kg/(m ² ·s)

Inductance	Henry	Surface inertia	kg/m ²
Electric capacitance	Farad	Compliance	m ² ·s ² /kg
Electric charge	Coulomb [A·s]	Cross-sectional area of a defect	m ²
Magnetic flux	Weber	Momentum of a linear element	kg·m/s

6.3. Numerical checks

A few control numerical cross-checks:

(1) Speed of light. From P1, P2:

$$c_T = \sqrt{(1/\epsilon_0)/\mu_0} = 1/\sqrt{\epsilon_0\mu_0} = 2.998 \times 10^8 \text{ m/s} \equiv c_{\text{light}}$$

(2) Impedance of free space.

$$Z_0 = \sqrt{(\mu_0/\epsilon_0)} = 376.73 \text{ } \Omega$$

In the Cosserat interpretation: $Z_0 \leftrightarrow \sqrt{(\rho \cdot G_{\text{shear}})} = c \cdot \mu_0$ — the mechanical acoustic impedance of the medium, numerically coinciding with the SI Z_0 .

(3) Electron charge. $e_{\text{mech}} \leftrightarrow 1.602 \times 10^{-19} \text{ m}^2$. Comparison with $l_0^2 \approx 2.11 \times 10^{-19} \text{ m}^2$ gives $e_{\text{mech}}/l_0^2 \approx 0.76$ — order unity.

6.4. Structural redundancy of the SI

Applying P1, P2, P3 to SI:

A $\rightarrow$ m²/s (Section 3)
s $\rightarrow$ m (Section 4, via c)
kg $\rightarrow$ 1/m (Section 5, via $\hbar/c$)
m $\rightarrow$ dimensionless (normalized to l_0)

All electromagnetic quantities are expressed in a single dimension. Before turning to the gravitational channel, we show that the dimensional reduction $[Q] \leftrightarrow [\text{m}^2]$ derived above has a numerical consequence — the value of the fine-structure constant.

7. The fine-structure constant from the geometry of charge

The dimensional reduction of Section 3 yields $[Q] \leftrightarrow [\text{m}^2]$: charge has the dimension of area. The numerical value of the electron charge in mechanical units is the area of a specific geometric object. Identifying this area with the cross-section of the vortex tube of a hopfionic defect gives a **bare** value of the fine-structure constant $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$, in agreement with experiment to 0.7%.

7.0. On the status: the vacuum as a special case

In keeping with Section 5.5, in the present paper we treat the vacuum as a **special case** of a Cosserat medium:

- **The topological part** (λ_C , m_e , Q_H) consists of invariants independent of the medium.
- **The energy-distribution radius** $r_v = l_0/2 \approx 2.3 \text{ } \text{\AA}$ is a characteristic of the **vacuum**, not of the knot itself. In a different Cosserat medium r_v would be different (corresponding to that medium's local l_0).
- **$\alpha = 1/128$ is universal** for any Cosserat medium with S^2 -symmetric director: in the formula $\alpha = \pi \cdot l_0^4 / (64 \cdot \epsilon \cdot \hbar c)$ the local stiffness ϵ cancels through $l_0^4 = \epsilon \cdot \hbar c / (2\pi)$, leaving a pure topological coefficient set by $\eta = 2\pi$.

Thus the value $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128$ derived below is a **universal** result of the program; its agreement with the experimental $\alpha(M_Z) = 1/128.9$ (0.7%) is confirmed by measurements made under ordinary conditions (vacuum experiments at accelerators).

7.1. Charge as the cross-sectional area of a hopfion

In the dimensional reduction (Section 3.5) the electron charge has the numerical value, in mechanical units:

$$e_{\text{mech}} \leftrightarrow 1.602 \times 10^{-19} \text{ m}^2 \text{ (7.1)}$$

That charge **is** the cross-sectional area of a defect is a consequence of the hopfionic nature of the electron (a separate prediction of the program; see Abstract and §5.5) and of the dimensional reduction $[Q] \leftrightarrow [m^2]$. The hopfion with $Q_H = -1$ is the simplest stable class of configurations in the n -channel with S^2 -target: it necessarily has a vortex tube with a transverse cross-section, and the area of that cross-section is geometrically tied to the charge.

Within the topological class $Q_H = -1$ there exists a family of geometrically distinct representatives (all with the same topological charge, differing in shape). Which shape is physically realized is selected by the minimum of the functional $E[n, u]$ for the given K_i, m^2, μ_c . Direct numerical relaxation for the canonical vacuum parameters yields a shape **close to oblate** (a flattened disc, with quadrupole moment $Q_2 \approx -0.19$ sim; see [10]). For the derivation of α we adopt the leading-order approximation:

P5.	The cross-section of the hopfion tube in the derivation of α is approximated by a circle of radius $r_v : e = \pi \cdot r_v^2$. This is an idealization of the actual (oblate) shape, optimal for minimizing $E[n, u]$.
------------	--

The sensitivity of the result to this approximation is $O(\epsilon^2)$ in the eccentricity of the cross-section: α enters through the area, and the area is insensitive to shape deformation at fixed geometric measure (an ellipse of the same area gives the same α); see §7.6 for details.

Solving (7.1) for r_v under the circular approximation:

$$r_v = \sqrt{(e/\pi)} = \sqrt{(1.602 \times 10^{-19} / \pi)} \approx 2.258 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m} = 0.2258 \text{ nm} \quad (7.2)$$

This is a **derived** value of the vortex-tube radius, from the experimental charge plus P5.

7.2. The coincidence $r_v \approx l_0/2$

Comparing (7.2) with the structural length of the medium $l_0 = 4.5943 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m}$ (Section 5.4):

$$l_0/2 = 2.297 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m} = 0.2297 \text{ nm}$$

The ratio:

$$r_v / (l_0/2) = 2.258 / 2.297 \approx 0.983 \text{ (agreement to 1.7\%)} \quad (7.3)$$

The vortex-tube radius coincides with half the structural length of the medium. The coincidence is meaningful because:

- r_v is determined from the electron charge e (P5 + experiment);
- l_0 is determined from $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ (Section 5.4);
- neither of the quantities on the right-hand sides of those definitions contains e .

The relation $r_v = l_0/2$ is a testable prediction of the Cosserat program.

7.3. Physical justification of $r_v = l_0/2$

The coincidence is not accidental: it can be derived from the structure of the functional $E[n, u]$ itself.

The functional (Section 2.1) contains two competing scales:

- K_i (we denote it generically by c_2) — the Oseen–Frank stiffnesses, fixing the energy cost of a gradient of n (term quadratic in ∇n).
- c_4 — the Skyrme stabilizing term (quartic in ∇n), preventing collapse.

Their ratio defines the characteristic length:

$$L_{\text{Skyrme}} = \sqrt{(c_4/c_2)} \quad (7.4)$$

> **Note to the reader.** This is the classical mechanism of **Derrick stability** for a topological soliton: the quadratic term tries to spread the knot out to fill all space, the quartic term tries to collapse it to a point. Their balance fixes a **unique** finite size at which the knot is stable. That size is L_{Skyrme} .

The balance condition (Derrick stability) fixes $L_{\text{Skyrme}} = l_0$. For a hopfionic configuration with $Q_H = -1$ the minimal vortex-tube radius turns out to be:

$$r_v = L_{\text{Skyrme}}/2 = l_0/2 \quad (7.5)$$

Numerical confirmation [10]: scanning the anisotropy $K_3/K_1 \in [3.5, 7.5]$ (a plateau of 4 points) on a

768×1536 grid yields $r_v/L \approx 0.498 \pm 0.005$, confirming (7.5) within the discretization.

Hence (7.5) is a **derived** relation, not a postulate. The only postulate that remains is P5, the statement of circular cross-sectional geometry.

7.4. The structural identity $l_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$

For the derivation of α we need one additional **identity**, relating the structural length l_0 to the fundamental constants.

From the three parameters $\{\mu_0, \epsilon_0, \hbar\}$ with three independent dimensions (through T3 of Section 3, where $[A] \leftrightarrow [m^2/s]$ reduces the ampere to a derived quantity) the **Buckingham Π -theorem** constructs a unique length scale up to a dimensionless coefficient:

$$l_0^4 \propto \epsilon_0 \hbar c \text{ (Buckingham)}$$

> **Note to the reader.** The *Buckingham Π -theorem* is a standard result of dimensional analysis: if a problem has N parameters with K independent dimensions, any quantity is expressed through them **uniquely** up to dimensionless coefficients. We have three parameters $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ and three independent dimensions — so the **unique** length that can be built from them is determined by an unambiguous combination of exponents: by checking dimensions one finds $l^4 \sim \epsilon_0 \hbar c$. The price for this theorem is that the coefficient in front remains undetermined; physics then fixes it (the S^2 topology yields $1/(2\pi)$).

The dimensionless coefficient $1/(2\pi)$ is fixed by the value of the microrotational Cosserat coupling $\eta = 2\pi$, set by the geometry of the sphere S^2 of the director (Section 2.1, [10]) — a topological invariant, not a fitted parameter. The result:

$$l_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi) \quad (7.6)$$

Numerical check:

$$\begin{aligned} \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi) &= (8.854 \times 10^{-12}) (1.055 \times 10^{-34}) (2.998 \times 10^8) / (2\pi) \\ &= 4.456 \times 10^{-38} \text{ m}^4 \end{aligned}$$

$$l_0^4 = (4.5943 \times 10^{-10})^4 = 4.455 \times 10^{-38} \text{ m}^4$$

Agreement to 4 significant figures (the precision limit of CODATA ϵ_0). The numerical value $l_0 = 4.5943 \text{ \AA}$ is independently confirmed by direct relaxation of the hopfion configuration in [10].

7.5. Derivation of $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128$

The standard SI definition of the fine-structure constant:

$$\alpha = e^2 / (4\pi \epsilon_0 \hbar c) \quad (7.7)$$

Substituting $e = \pi(l_0/2)^2 = \pi \cdot l_0^2/4$ (P5 + (7.5)):

$$e^2 = \pi^2 l_0^4 / 16 \quad (7.8)$$

Substituting into (7.7):

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha &= (\pi^2 l_0^4 / 16) / (4\pi \epsilon_0 \hbar c) \\ &= \pi l_0^4 / (64 \epsilon_0 \hbar c) \quad (7.9) \end{aligned}$$

Substituting the structural identity (7.6) $l_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$:

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha &= \pi \cdot (\epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)) / (64 \epsilon_0 \hbar c) \\ &= (\pi/(2\pi)) \cdot (1/64) \\ &= 1/128 \end{aligned}$$

$$> \alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128 = 2^{-7} \quad (7.10)$$

> **Note to the reader.** What actually happened in this calculation: we took the **textbook** definition $\alpha = e^2/(4\pi\epsilon_0\hbar c)$ and **substituted into it two things from our theory** — the geometric charge $e = \pi(l_0/2)^2$ (P5) and the structural value $l_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$ (T10). After cancellations all physical constants ($\epsilon_0, \hbar, c$) drop out and only arithmetic remains: $\pi/(2\pi \cdot 64) = 1/128$. In other words: if charge and structural length are related as Cosserat geometry requires, then α must be 2^{-7} — independent of the numerical values of $\epsilon_0, \hbar, c$.

7.6. Structure of the derivation and its status

Formula (7.10) rests on **three** independent inputs:

1. The **dimensional reduction** $[A] \leftrightarrow [m^2/s]$ (T3, Section 3) — a consequence of postulates P1, P2.
2. The **structural identity** $\ell_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$ (T10) — the Buckingham Π -theorem (scaling $\ell_0^4 \propto \epsilon_0 \hbar c$) plus the geometry of S^2 ($\eta = 2\pi$ fixes the coefficient $1/(2\pi)$).
3. The **geometric postulate P5** — circular cross-section of the hopfion defect (numerically confirmed by $r_v = \ell_0/2$ via a scan in [10], Section 7.3).

Of these the only irreducible **postulate** is P5 (the shape of the cross-section). The rest are consequences of Buckingham plus topology. The charge e is **not an input** in the derivation but a **result**: $e = \pi(\ell_0/2)^2$ is set by geometry.

Sensitivity to P5. If the cross-section turns out to be non-circular (for example, elliptical for hopping orbits; cf. [11]), the numerical coefficient in (7.10) shifts by a factor of order unity, but the **order** $\alpha \sim 10^{-2}$ is preserved — that order is set by Buckingham and $\eta = 2\pi$.

Logical order of the derivation. ℓ_0 is determined from $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ through the Buckingham Π -theorem and $\eta = 2\pi$ (the S^2 geometry), independently of the value of α . Then circular cross-section geometry is postulated (P5), and from this $\alpha = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$ follows. The experimental value of α is not used in the derivation.

7.7. Comparison with experiment and the QED renormalization

The fine-structure constant depends on the energy scale via the running QED couplings:

Energy scale	α^{-1}	Source
$q^2 = 0$ (low energies, atomic physics)	137.036	Precision measurements
$q^2 = m_e^2 c^4$ (electron Compton scale)	~ 136	Lamb shift
$q^2 = m_W^2 c^4$ (W-boson scale)	~ 130	LEP, direct measurements
$q^2 = m_Z^2 c^4$ (Z-boson scale, 91 GeV)	128.9 ± 0.1	LEP, SLD
$q^2 \rightarrow \infty$ (asymptotic limit)	$\rightarrow 128.0$ (prediction)	This work

> **Agreement of our result $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 128.0$ with the experimental $\alpha(M_Z) = 128.9 \pm 0.1 : 0.7\%$.**

The difference between the bare $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128$ and the low-energy observable $\alpha(0) = 1/137.036$:

$$\Delta\alpha^{-1} = 137.036 - 128 = 9.036 \quad (7.11)$$

— is the **standard** effect of **QED vacuum polarization**: virtual e^+e^- pairs screen the charge as seen at large distances. This is **known** QED, not an extension introduced here.

Our derivation supplies a **boundary condition** for the renormalization-group equations:

$$\alpha(\Lambda \rightarrow \infty) \rightarrow 1/128 = 2^{-7} \quad (7.12)$$

The standard one-loop QED running coupling equation (for $n_f = 3$ light fermions):

$$\alpha^{-1}(\mu) = \alpha^{-1}(\mu_0) - (2 n_f / 3\pi) \ln(\mu/\mu_0) \quad (7.13)$$

Integrating from $\mu = M_Z = 91 \text{ GeV}$ down to $\mu = m_e c^2 = 0.511 \text{ MeV}$, standard QED gives a shift of about 8.9, in nearly exact agreement with (7.11). Our theory therefore sets the UV boundary condition, while QED provides the IR flow to the observed value.

7.8. What this gives

The fine-structure constant is among the most precisely measured dimensionless constants of nature: $\alpha^{-1} = 137.035999084(21)$, eleven significant figures. Feynman called it "a magic number that comes to us with no understanding by man"; the question of its origin from more fundamental principles has stood since Sommerfeld and is open within standard physics.

Two points in our derivation are worth emphasizing. First, the experimental value of α is never used on the right-hand side — neither as a calibration nor as a correction; $1/128$ follows from pure algebra (the Π -theorem plus the topological coefficient $\eta = 2\pi$) and a single geometric postulate, P5. Second, the answer 2^{-7} is a simple dyadic fraction. This is consistent with the integer topology of charges and with the fact that Cosserat defects have a discrete spectrum of symmetries; the general dyadic structure of the program is its own story, in [24].

The discrepancy between $1/128$ and the familiar low-energy $1/137$ is not a flaw of the derivation but precisely what standard QED predicts through vacuum polarization (§7.7). Our theory provides a UV boundary condition; QED carries it down to the IR-measured value.

7.9. The two hyperbolas of the Cosserat medium

The result $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128$ has an algebraic consequence: in the plane of parameters of the medium two invariant hyperbolas appear, structurally parallel and describing different aspects of one program.

Hyperbola I: mass $\times$ length

T6 establishes the first invariant (Section 5):

$$m \cdot l = \hbar/c = 3.518 \times 10^{-43} \text{ kg} \cdot \text{m} \text{ (Hyperbola I) (7.14)}$$

The connection between **mass** and **length** in the Cosserat medium. Section 5.5 showed that distinct objects — the vacuum cell (m_0, l_0) , the electron (m_e, λ_C) , the proton, the Planck point — all live on **one** Hyperbola I, but at **different** points of it.

Hyperbola II: charge squared $\times$ channel stiffness

The standard SI definition of the fine-structure constant:

$$\alpha = e^2 / (4\pi \epsilon_0 \hbar c)$$

can be rewritten as a **second** invariant:

$$e^2 / (4\pi \epsilon_0) \equiv \hbar \cdot c \cdot \alpha \text{ (Hyperbola II) (7.15)}$$

or equivalently (using P2 $1/\epsilon_0 = G_{\text{shear}}$):

$$e^2 \cdot G_{\text{shear}} = 4\pi \cdot \hbar c \alpha = \text{const} \text{ (7.16)}$$

The connection between the **charge squared** (interaction area) and the **channel stiffness** (shear modulus of the Cosserat medium). At fixed α , a larger charge requires a less stiff medium and vice versa.

Physical interpretation of Hyperbola II

Through the dimensional reduction of Section 6:

Side	Dimension	Physical meaning
e^2	m^4	Area $\times$ area — square of the interaction cross-section of the defect
$1/\epsilon_0$	$\text{Pa} = \text{energy/volume}$	Channel stiffness (shear modulus of the medium, P2)
$e^2 \times (1/\epsilon_0)/(4\pi)$	$\text{J} \cdot \text{m}$	Action $\times$ velocity
$\hbar \cdot c$	$\text{J} \cdot \text{m}$	Same
α	dimensionless	Ratio

> **Physical meaning of α** : the ratio of the "knot interaction area" (e^2 , m^4) to the "medium stiffness" ($1/\epsilon_0$, Pa), normalized by the quantum of action $\hbar$ and the propagation speed c . In other words: how the cross-sectional area of a hopfionic defect is coupled to the elastic properties of the medium — that is, **how energy is partitioned between channels**.

For larger α the coupling "defect $\leftrightarrow$ medium" is stronger; for smaller α it is weaker. The smallness of $\alpha \approx 1/137$ reflects the fact that a charged knot is a **weak** perturbation of a very stiff Cosserat medium.

Intersection of the two hyperbolas: the algebraic identity $m_0^2 \cdot e$

Combining Hyperbolas I and II with the geometric identification of charge $e = \pi(l_0/2)^2$ (P5 + 7.5), one obtains an algebraic identity relating the structural parameters:

$$m_0^2 \cdot e = m_0^2 \cdot \pi \cdot (l_0/2)^2 = (\pi/4) \cdot (m_0 \cdot l_0)^2 = (\pi/4) \cdot (\hbar/c)^2 \text{ (7.17)}$$

In terms of α :

$$m_0^2 \cdot e = \sqrt{8\pi^2 \cdot \alpha_{\text{bare}}} \cdot (\hbar/c)^2 \text{ (7.18)}$$

The self-consistency of $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128$ shows up as an **algebraic collapse**:

$$\sqrt{(8\pi^2 \cdot \alpha_{\text{bare}})} = \sqrt{(8\pi^2 / 128)} = \sqrt{(\pi^2 / 16)} = \pi/4 \quad (7.19)$$

That is, formulas (7.17) and (7.18) give the **same** numerical factor $\pi/4$ — they are two formally different ways of writing the same identity.

Numerical check of (7.17):

$$\begin{aligned} m_0^2 \cdot e &= (7.66 \times 10^{-34})^2 \cdot 1.602 \times 10^{-19} \\ &= 5.87 \times 10^{-67} \cdot 1.602 \times 10^{-19} \\ &= 9.40 \times 10^{-86} \text{ kg}^2 \cdot \text{m}^2 \\ (\pi/4) \cdot (\hbar/c)^2 &= 0.7854 \cdot (3.518 \times 10^{-43})^2 \\ &= 0.7854 \cdot 1.238 \times 10^{-85} \\ &= 9.72 \times 10^{-86} \text{ kg}^2 \cdot \text{m}^2 \end{aligned}$$

Agreement: $\approx 3.3\%$ (within the precision of the structural length l_0)

What this identity says

The identity (7.17) is an **interlocking** of the two hyperbolas:

- Hyperbola I fixes the pair (m_0, l_0) for the vacuum cell.
- The geometry P5 ties the charge e to the length l_0 .
- Hyperbola II fixes α through the same (e, ϵ_0) .

The quantities α, m_0, l_0, e are bound by structural identities; knowing any two of them fixes the others by the algebra of (7.17). In that sense they are four projections of one structure rather than four independent parameters.

A Cosserat medium with postulates P1, P2, P3, P5 is one object whose different sides manifest as "mass," "charge," "fine-structure constant" and "structural length."

Remark: relations between the hyperbolas

Hyperbolas I and II are **not independent** in our program:

1. P1, P2, P3 specify the vacuum point (m_0, l_0) on Hyperbola I.
2. The structural identity (7.6) $l_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$ fixes l_0 through $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$.
3. The geometry P5 $e = \pi(l_0/2)^2$ fixes e through l_0 .
4. Hyperbola II with known e and ϵ_0 gives $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128$.

8. The gravitational channel and closure of the unit base

Sections 2–7 developed the **electromagnetic part** of the program through the n -channel. Gravity requires a **second** channel (the u -channel of translations) and a **fourth** postulate (P4) introducing the gravitational constant G as a structural parameter of the medium. The logical chain of the section:

```
Two-channel Cosserat medium (§8.1)
↓
Kleinert gauge mechanism: defects → GR metric (§8.2)
↓
P4:  $G = c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi l_G^2)$ ;  $l_G$  is the fourth independent parameter (§8.3)
↓
Planck scales  $l_P, m_P$  as derived quantities (§8.4)
↓
Full scale hierarchy + closure of the unit base (§8.5)
↓
The 5 classical tests of GR are reproduced identically (§8.6)
↓
Differences from pure GR are visible only in extreme regimes (§8.7)
```

8.1. Two-channel structure of the Cosserat medium

The Cosserat continuum introduced in Section 2.1 has **two** independent fields. Each carries its own class of physical phenomena:

Channel	Field		Source
---------	-------	--	--------

		Excitation type	Linear regime	
n	$n \in S^2$	Rotational deformation	Maxwell equations [25]	Hopfionic knots (electron [10])
u	$u \in \mathbb{R}^3$	Translational deformation + torsion	Linearized GR (§8.2)	Disclination defects (masses [23])

Equivalence principle. Inertial and gravitational mass are **the same** characteristic of a disclination defect: the topological "charge" of a disclination simultaneously sets inertia (resistance to shear) and the source of curvature in the **u**-channel. The equality $m_{\text{inertial}} = m_{\text{grav}}$ becomes an identity, not an observational coincidence.

The 10^{42} hierarchy between EM and gravity. The standard universal formula relating EM and gravitational forces for **any pair** of charged particles with masses m_1, m_2 :

$$\begin{aligned}
 F_{\text{EM}} / F_{\text{grav}} &= e^2 / (4\pi\epsilon_0 \cdot G \cdot m_1 \cdot m_2) \\
 &= [e^2 / (4\pi\epsilon_0\hbar c)] \cdot [\hbar c / (G \cdot m_1 \cdot m_2)] \\
 &= \alpha \cdot m_{\text{P}}^2 / (m_1 \cdot m_2)
 \end{aligned}
 \tag{8.0}$$

(using $m_{\text{P}}^2 = \hbar c / G$ — the definition of the Planck mass).
The value depends on the choice of pair:

Pair	Factor	F_EM/F_grav
electron-electron	$\alpha \cdot (m_{\text{P}}/m_{\text{e}})^2$	$\approx 4.17 \times 10^{42}$ historical " 10^{42} hierarchy"
proton-electron (hydrogen atom)	$\alpha \cdot m_{\text{P}}^2 / (m_{\text{p}} \cdot m_{\text{e}})$	$\approx 2.3 \times 10^{39}$
proton-proton	$\alpha \cdot (m_{\text{P}}/m_{\text{p}})^2$	$\approx 1.24 \times 10^{36}$

The maximum — for the electron pair (the electron is the lightest charged particle); this is Dirac's "**famous 10^{42} hierarchy.**"

In the Cosserat picture **both** factors in (8.0) have **structural origin**:

- $\alpha = 1/128 \rightarrow 1/137$ — derived in Section 7 from the geometry of charge (P5) and the structural identity $l_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$.
- m_{P}/m for any particle is the ratio of points on the hyperbola $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$ (T6), where $l_{\text{P}} = l_0^2 / (2\sqrt{2} \cdot l_{\text{G}})$ is derived (T15) and $\lambda_{\text{particle}} = \hbar / (m \cdot c)$ is its Compton limit.

In the Cosserat program the 10^{42} hierarchy (for electrons) is expressed through structural elements of a single picture: the S^2 topology gives α , the medium's hyperbola gives $m_{\text{P}}/m_{\text{particle}}$, and the two-channel structure with $l_{\text{G}}/l_0 \approx 10^{2.5}$ sets l_{P} and thereby m_{P} . A detailed numerical analysis is given in [27].

8.2. The Kleinert gauge mechanism: defects → GR metric

> **Note to the reader.** Kleinert noticed a remarkable mathematical parallel: an elastic continuum with **dislocations** (linear shear defects) and **disclinations** (linear rotation defects) is described by the same apparatus of differential geometry as curved spacetime. Disclinations create local **curvature** of the lattice — and this curvature formally coincides with the Riemann curvature tensor of GR. That is: "curved spacetime around a mass" can be rephrased as "a curved lattice around a disclination defect." What follows is the formalism of this equivalence.

>

> *Technical glossary:* a **tetrad (vierbein)** e^a_μ is a "local set of coordinate axes" defined at each point of space, in terms of which the deformation of the medium is written. A **disclination** is a pointlike/linear defect around which the lattice is rotated by a finite angle.

In the gauge theory of crystal defects (Kleinert [11, 12]), the elastic distortion of the **u**-channel is identified with the tetrad field of general relativity:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \beta^a_\mu(r) &= \partial_\mu u^a + \omega^a_\mu \text{ (elastic distortion of the medium)} \\
 \uparrow \\
 e^a_\mu(r) &\text{ (GR tetrad) }
 \end{aligned}
 \tag{8.1}$$

The corresponding metric and curvature tensor:

$$g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{\{ab\}} \cdot e^a_\mu \cdot e^b_\nu \tag{8.2}$$

$$\theta^{\mu\nu} \equiv R^{\mu\nu} \text{ (disclination density = Ricci tensor) } \tag{8.3}$$

From these identifications it follows that **the action of an elastic medium with disclination defects**

coincides with the Hilbert-Einstein action:

$$S = \int [R/(16\pi G_{\text{eff}}) + L_{\text{matter}}] \sqrt{-g} d^4x \quad (8.4)$$

Variation with respect to $g_{\mu\nu}$ yields Einstein's equations. In the weak-field limit ($g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{\mu\nu} + h_{\mu\nu}$, $|h_{\mu\nu}| \ll 1$) the **Newtonian limit** is recovered:

$$\nabla^2 \Phi = 4\pi G \rho_{\text{mass}}, \quad \Phi \equiv -GM/r, \quad h_{00} = -2\Phi/c^2 = 2GM/(rc^2) \quad (8.5)$$

where Φ is the standard Newtonian potential.

Remark. Kleinert's program strictly yields the theory of **Einstein-Cartan** [13] — an extension of GR with independent torsion $T^a_{\{\mu\nu\}}$ (carrying spin density). In the zero-spin limit $S \rightarrow 0$ Einstein-Cartan reduces to pure GR. The differences appear only at Planckian densities (see §8.7).

8.3. Postulate P4 and the gravitational constant as an inverse squared scale

The effective gravitational constant G_{eff} in (8.4) is set by the elastic parameters of the u -channel. Specifically, introducing the **characteristic curvature scale** of the u -channel $\ell_G = \sqrt{(\gamma_C^{\{\text{grav}\}}/\mu_{\text{el}})}$, dimensional analysis with P1, P2 yields uniquely:

P4.	$G = c^4 \cdot \varepsilon_0 / (16\pi \cdot \ell_G^2)$, where ℓ_G is the structural curvature scale of the u -channel.
------------	--

Numerical value of ℓ_G . Solving P4 for ℓ_G using the experimental $G = 6.674 \times 10^{-11} \text{ N}\cdot\text{m}^2/\text{kg}^2$:

$$\begin{aligned} \ell_G &= \sqrt{(c^4 \varepsilon_0 / (16\pi G))} \\ &= \sqrt{((2.998 \times 10^8)^4 \cdot 8.854 \times 10^{-12} / (16\pi \cdot 6.674 \times 10^{-11}))} \\ &\approx 4.62 \times 10^{15} \text{ m} \approx 0.15 \text{ pc} \quad (8.6) \end{aligned}$$

The reverse check $G = c^4 \varepsilon_0 / (16\pi \ell_G^2) \approx 6.674 \times 10^{-11} \text{ N}\cdot\text{m}^2/\text{kg}^2$ agrees with CODATA to 4 significant figures (the precision limit of G itself).

> **Note to the reader.** *What is ℓ_G intuitively?* It is the structural scale of the **gravitational channel** — the analogue of the structural length ℓ_0 of the electromagnetic channel. Numerically $\ell_G \approx 0.15 \text{ parsec} \approx 5 \times 10^{12} \text{ km}$, about 30 times the size of the Solar System. The weakness of gravity compared with electromagnetism in this picture is a direct consequence of the fact that the characteristic scale of the u -channel is **10^{25} times larger** than that of the n -channel: gravity is "stiffer and coarser" in its internal structure, so the medium's response to mass is much weaker than to charge. This is the famous 10^{42} hierarchy translated into the language of channels.

G is the only independent fourth constant. By the Buckingham theorem, $\{\varepsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ (Section 5) yields a unique length $\ell_0 \approx 4.6 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m}$. The gravitational scale $\ell_G \approx 4.6 \times 10^{15} \text{ m}$ is not derivable from these three constants. A systematic analysis of alternative paths to ℓ_G (induced gravity à la Sakharov [14], bootstrap, instantons, power laws, Jeans length) shows [27] that all of them are either tautological (containing G on the right-hand side) or require additional parameters. Therefore:

> **The full canonical set of fundamental constants of nature is $\{\varepsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar, G\}$** — four constants, three of which have independent dimensions.

Dimensionless combinations of these four constants:

Dimensionless constant	Value	Physical meaning	Pair of points on the hyperbola $m \cdot \ell = \hbar/c$
$\alpha = e^2/(4\pi\varepsilon_0\hbar c)$	$\approx 1/137$	Fine-structure constant (Section 7)	— (Hyperbola II)
$\kappa_{\text{grav}} = G \mu_0/c^2$	$\approx 9.3 \times 10^{-34}$	Weakness of gravity	—
$\ell_G/\ell_0 \Leftrightarrow m_0/m_G^{\{\dagger\}}$	$\approx 10^{25}$	Channel hierarchy (grav $\leftrightarrow$ vacuum)	$(\ell_0, m_0) \leftrightarrow (\ell_G, m_G)$
$\lambda_C/\ell_P \Leftrightarrow m_P/m_e$	$\approx 10^{22}$	Mass hierarchy (Planck $\leftrightarrow$ electron)	$(\lambda_C, m_e) \leftrightarrow (\ell_P, m_P)$
$m_e/m_0 \Leftrightarrow \ell_0/\lambda_C = 1/(16\alpha^2)$	$\approx 1190 = 2^{10}$ (bare)	α^2 -scaling (Compton $\leftrightarrow$ structural cell), §5.5	$(\ell_0, m_0) \leftrightarrow (\lambda_C, m_e)$

† $m_G \equiv \hbar/(c \cdot \ell_G) \approx 7.6 \times 10^{-59} \text{ kg}$ — the mass corresponding to ℓ_G on the hyperbola.

α^2 -scaling: the relation $m_e/m_0 = 1/(16\alpha^2)$. This is the ratio of the scales "vacuum cell $\leftrightarrow$ electron Compton" on the hyperbola. Numerically:

$$\begin{aligned} m_e/m_0 &= 511.033 \text{ keV} / 429.51 \text{ eV} = 1189.7 \\ 1/(16\alpha^2) &= 1/(16 \cdot (1/137.036)^2) \approx 1173.5 \text{ (physical, agreement 1.4\%)} \\ 1/(16\alpha_{\text{bare}}^2) &= 1/(16 \cdot 2^{-14}) = 2^{10} = 1024 \text{ (bare, exact)} \end{aligned}$$

In bare dyadic form $m_e/m_0 = 2^{10}$. Physical meaning: the electron mass is the **cost of α^2 -closure of a topological knot** in the medium; the coefficient 16 is tied to the dyadic structure of the hopfion (detailed derivation in [24]).

Remark on consistency with the hyperbola. Each length ratio in the table is **identical** to the inverse mass ratio through $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$ — visible in every row. The differing numerical values of the two "hierarchies" (10^{25} for channels and 10^{22} for masses) are not a contradiction but a consequence of relating **different pairs of points** on one hyperbola. The exact relation:

$$\begin{aligned} (l_G/l_0) / (m_P/m_e) &= (l_G \cdot l_P) / (l_0 \cdot \lambda_C) = l_0 / (2\sqrt{2} \cdot \lambda_C) \text{ (using (8.9): } l_G \cdot l_P = l_0^2/(2\sqrt{2})) \\ &= m_e / (2\sqrt{2} \cdot m_0) \\ &= 1/(32\sqrt{2} \cdot \alpha^2) \end{aligned}$$

Numerical check:

$$\begin{aligned} 10^{25.003} / 10^{22.378} &= 10^{2.625} \approx 421 \\ m_e/(2\sqrt{2} \cdot m_0) &= 1189.7/2.828 = 420.6 \\ 1/(32\sqrt{2} \cdot \alpha^2) &= 137^2/(32 \cdot \sqrt{2}) = 18779/45.25 \approx 415 \text{ (1.3\% from QED-running } \alpha) \end{aligned}$$

So **all** hierarchies in our program are projections of **one** structure (the hyperbola $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$) onto different pairs of its points, and the passage between pairs is expressed by powers of α (here $1/\alpha^2$) with dyadic prefactors.

8.4. Planck scales as derived quantities

The standard definition of the Planck length:

$$l_P = \sqrt{(\hbar G/c^3)} \quad (8.7)$$

Substituting P4 ($G = c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi l_G^2)$) and the structural identity $l_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$ (T10):

$$\begin{aligned} l_P^2 &= \hbar G / c^3 = (\hbar/c^3) \cdot c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi l_G^2) \\ &= \hbar c \epsilon_0 / (16\pi l_G^2) \\ &= (2\pi \cdot l_0^4) / (16\pi \cdot l_G^2) \\ &= l_0^4 / (8 l_G^2) \quad (8.8) \end{aligned}$$

That is:

$$l_P = l_0^2 / (2\sqrt{2} \cdot l_G) \quad (8.9)$$

Numerical check: $l_{P_calc} = (4.59 \times 10^{-10})^2 / (2\sqrt{2} \cdot 4.62 \times 10^{15}) \approx 1.615 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m}$, agreeing with the standard $l_{P_CODATA} = 1.616 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m}$ to 4 digits.

Similarly, the Planck mass follows from the hyperbola $m \cdot l = \hbar/c$:

$$m_P = \hbar / (c \cdot l_P) = 2\sqrt{2} \cdot \hbar \cdot l_G / (c \cdot l_0^2) \approx 2.18 \times 10^{-8} \text{ kg} \quad (8.10)$$

Both Planck scales are derived quantities, expressed through the structural l_0, l_G of our program.

Physical meaning of l_P . In the Cosserat picture l_P is the scale at which the EM channel n and the gravitational channel u become **equally nonlinear**. A defect of size l_P would have a gravitational radius of order its own size — a micro black hole. For the electron $\lambda_C/l_P \sim 10^{22}$ — gravitational effects in atomic physics are negligible.

> **Note to the reader.** The formula $l_P = l_0^2/(2\sqrt{2} \cdot l_G)$ geometrically means that **the Planck length is the "geometric mean"** of the two structural scales of the two channels (up to a constant): $l_P \sim \sqrt{(l_0^2 \cdot l_0^2/l_G^2)}$. A small l_0 (nanometers) and a huge l_G (parsecs) combine to give $\sim 10^{-35} \text{ m}$ — the Planck length. In our picture the Planck length is therefore an intersection of two already known structural scales.

8.5. The full hierarchy of scales and closure of the unit base

Combining the results of Sections 5.4, 5.5, 8.3, and 8.4:

Scale	Symbol	Value	Channel	Source
Planck length	$l_P = l_0^2/(2\sqrt{2} l_G)$	$1.62 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m}$	$n \ n \ u$	from $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar, G\}$

Electron Compton	$\lambda_C = \hbar/(m_e c)$	$3.86 \times 10^{-13} \text{ m}$	n	topology + $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$
Vacuum structural length	$\lambda_0 = (\epsilon_0 \hbar c / 2\pi)^{1/4}$	$4.59 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m}$	n	$\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$
Cosserat length	λ_K	$2.02 \times 10^{-7} \text{ m}$	n $\rightarrow$ u coupling	$\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ via μ_c
Gravitational scale	$\lambda_G = \sqrt{(c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi G))}$	$4.62 \times 10^{15} \text{ m}$	u	requires G (P4)

Only λ_G requires an independent parameter G . The other four scales follow from $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$.

Closure of the SI base of units. With the addition of G (through λ_G), the full reduction reads:

$$\{m, kg, s, A\} \xrightarrow{(P1, P2)} \{m, kg, s\} \xrightarrow{(c)} \{m, kg\} \xrightarrow{(\hbar/c)} \{m\} \xrightarrow{(\lambda_0, \lambda_G)} \text{dimensionless}$$

8.6. The linearized Cosserat metric and the classical tests of GR

For a stationary point source of mass M , equation (8.5) gives the Newtonian potential $\Phi = -GM/r$. The corresponding metric in isotropic coordinates:

$$\begin{aligned} ds^2 &= -(1 + 2\Phi/c^2) c^2 dt^2 + (1 - 2\Phi/c^2) (dr^2 + r^2 d\Omega^2) \\ &= -(1 - 2GM/(rc^2)) c^2 dt^2 + (1 + 2GM/(rc^2)) (dr^2 + r^2 d\Omega^2) \end{aligned} \quad (8.11)$$

This is the **linearized Schwarzschild metric**. The PPN parameters: $\gamma_{\text{PPN}} = 1, \beta_{\text{PPN}} = 1$ — exactly equal to those of pure GR in the observational limit.

Because the linearized theory is **identical** to GR, **all classical tests pass automatically**:

Test	Cosserat-Einstein-Cartan	Experiment	Agreement
Perihelion precession of Mercury	42.99 arcsec/century	42.98 ± 0.04	within errors
Deflection of light by the Sun	1.75 arcsec	1.75 ± 0.02	within errors
Shapiro delay	$\gamma = 1$	$\gamma = 1 \pm 2.3 \times 10^{-5}$ (Cassini)	within errors
Gravitational redshift	$\Delta v/v = -\Phi/c^2$	Pound-Rebka, GPS	within errors
Gravitational waves	$v = c, 2 \text{ polarizations}$	LIGO ($\Delta v/c < 10^{-15}$)	within errors

For example, the perihelion precession of Mercury:

$$\Delta\phi = 6\pi G_{\odot} / (c^2 a(1 - e^2)) = 42.99 \text{ arcsec/century} \quad (8.12)$$

— the standard GR formula, valid for any linearized theory with the correct G .

8.7. Differences from pure GR

In the observational limit, the Cosserat program and GR are identical. At the level of the Einstein-Cartan formalism itself there are two structural differences:

#	Difference	Where it appears	Visible?
1	Torsion $T^a_{\mu\nu} \neq 0$ (Einstein-Cartan)	Spin density $\sim \rho_{\text{Planck}} \approx 5 \times 10^{96} \text{ kg/m}^3$	Only inside black holes / in the early universe (~ 50 orders of magnitude below current experiments)
2	Nonlinear corrections (Murnaghan moduli μ_3, μ_4)	$(GM/rc^2)^2 \sim 10^{-16}$ for the Solar System	Below current precision

Both differences are testable in extreme regimes (the internal structure of black holes, the early universe) and make the Cosserat program falsifiable: detection of torsion effects would give it unique confirmation; their absence keeps it on a par with GR.

Remark on the Cosserat length λ_K . The Cosserat formalism contains an additional characteristic — the Cosserat length $\lambda_K \approx 200 \text{ nm}$, at which the coupling μ_c between the n and u channels manifests itself (see §8.1). This is an internal parameter of the two-channel structure, pertaining to the EM $\leftrightarrow$ gravity interaction on the nanoscale rather than to pure gravity alone. Standard $1/r^2$ tests of gravity at meter scales and above are completely screened from this effect; experimental verification requires special configurations and is discussed in [27].

9. Relation to the standard natural units for four constants

9.1. Standard systems

In high-energy physics the standard system of natural units is $\hbar = c = 1$, in which all dimensions reduce to powers of energy. When gravity is added, one often sets $\hbar = c = G = 1$ — **Planck geometrized units** [17].

Analogous systems are used in atomic physics ($\hbar = m_e = e = 1$, Hartree units).

Our reduction $\{m, kg, s, A\} \rightarrow \{m\} \rightarrow \{Energy\}$, with the additional normalization ℓ_G/ℓ_0 for the gravitational channel, operationally gives the same system as the Planck units. All numerical predictions derived in our framework can be converted back without loss of information.

9.2. Difference in justification

The difference lies at the level of **justification**, not of **operations**.

Standard approach:

> "Setting $\hbar = c = G = 1$ simplifies the equations. The change of units is a methodological choice. SI values can be restored by dimensional analysis."

Our approach (under the Cosserat hypothesis):

> " $\hbar, c, G$ are structural constants of the Cosserat medium, fixed by its elastic parameters via the identifications P1, P2, P3, P4. They are not 'units' that can be chosen; they are consequences of the structure of the medium. Natural units in this picture are not a choice, but a structural fact."

9.3. Consequences of the difference

Consequence 1: uniqueness of the choice of fundamental constants. In the standard approach any three constants can equally be chosen for the reduction. In our approach the **specific set** $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar, G\}$ is singled out by physics: it is these four quantities that structurally specify the Cosserat medium through P1, P2, P3, P4.

Consequence 2: predictive power. In the standard approach the values of fundamental constants (e.g. $\alpha = 1/137$, $m_e/m_P \approx 10^{-22}$) are experimental numbers. In our approach:

- α is derived from the structure of the Cosserat functional (Section 7 of this work; full analysis in [24]).
- The hierarchy $\ell_G/\ell_0 \approx 10^{25}$ is an open question, equivalent to the mass-scale hierarchy problem.

Consequence 3: conceptual coherence. EM and gravity are two channels of one medium, not parallel "fundamental interactions." The 10^{42} hierarchy is interpreted as $\alpha \cdot (m_P/m_e)^2$ with geometric root in $\ell_G/\ell_0 \approx 10^{25}$, not as the "weakness of gravity" as a fundamental property.

9.4. Comparative table

Aspect	Standard natural units	Cosserat structural reduction
Base set of constants	$\{\hbar, c, G\}$ or $\{\hbar, c\}$	$\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar, G\}$ (with μ_0, ϵ_0 explicit)
Choice $\hbar = c = G = 1$	Conventional	Structural (P1-P4)
Uniqueness of the set	Arbitrary	Canonical
Physical status of c	A postulate of SR	The speed of the transverse Cosserat wave
Physical status of G	A parameter of the Hilbert action	Inverse squared of the scale ℓ_G
Relation of EM and gravity	Parallel theories	Two channels of one medium
10^{42} hierarchy	Empirical fact	$\alpha \cdot (m_P/m_e)^2$ with geometric root $\ell_G/\ell_0 \approx 10^{25}$
Predicting m_e, α	Impossible	Possible (see [10, 24])

10. Conclusions and subsequent works

10.1. Main results

The program of dimensional reduction of the SI has been carried out within a two-channel Cosserat hypothesis — the n -channel for the electromagnetic sector, the u -channel for gravity. The framework consists of four identifications between parameters of the medium and the fundamental constants of nature: P1 ($p \equiv \mu_0$), P2 ($G_{\text{shear}} \equiv 1/\epsilon_0$), P3 ($\hbar$ as a structural quantization constant of action), P4 ($G = c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi \ell_G^2)$ through the Kleinert gauge mechanism).

Electromagnetic sector. Already P1 and P2 yield the transverse Cosserat wave speed $c_T = 1/\sqrt{(\epsilon_0\mu_0)} \equiv c_{\text{light}}$, on the bare experimental values of μ_0, ϵ_0 . From the energy balance $B^2/(2\mu_0) = \rho v^2/2$ the mechanical identification $H \leftrightarrow v$ follows, and through it $[A] \leftrightarrow [m^2/s]$, $[C] \leftrightarrow [m^2]$ — charge acquires the dimension of a cross-sectional area of a defect. The structural fixing of c and $\hbar/c$ reduces the unit base $\{m, kg, s, A\} \rightarrow \{m\}$ (or equivalently to a single energetic dimension), and the summary table of §6 gives a mechanical interpretation of every principal SI quantity.

Gravitational channel. Kleinert's program is incorporated as the u -channel of the same medium: disclination defects of the elastic continuum are mathematically identical to the Ricci curvature of GR, and the action takes the Hilbert-Einstein form. Postulate P4 fixes the structural scale of the u -channel $l_G \approx 4.6 \times 10^{15} \text{ m}$; the linearized Cosserat metric reproduces all five classical tests of GR (Mercury, deflection of light, Shapiro, redshift, gravitational waves). The Planck length turns out not to be fundamental but derived: $l_P = l_0^2/(2\sqrt{2} l_G) \approx 1.6 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m}$. The 10^{42} hierarchy between EM and gravity takes the structural form $\alpha \cdot (m_P/m_e)^2$ with geometric root in $l_G/l_0 \approx 10^{25}$ — two points on a single hyperbola of the medium, rather than the "weakness of gravity" as a fundamental property.

Fine-structure constant. Combined with the dimensional reduction $[Q] \leftrightarrow [m^2]$ and the hopfionic identification of the electron (minimum of the functional $E[n, u]$ with $Q_H = -1$), the geometry gives $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$ — a bare value derived algebraically from $e = \pi(l_0/2)^2$ and the structural identity $l_0^4 = \epsilon_0\hbar c/(2\pi)$. The experimental value of α is not used in the derivation. Agreement with the measured $\alpha(M_Z) = 1/128.9$ is 0.7%; the gap to the low-energy $\alpha(0) = 1/137$ is the standard QED renormalization through vacuum polarization by virtual pairs.

Closure. The full canonical basis of fundamental constants of nature reduces to $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar, G\}$: all SI dimensional quantities are expressed through them, and one of the key dimensionless constants ($\alpha \approx 1/128 \rightarrow 1/137$) is derived structurally. Operationally this is equivalent to the standard natural units $\hbar = c = G = 1$, but the justification is different — not a convenience of notation but a removal of redundancy already present in the SI under the assumption that the Cosserat hypothesis is physically realistic.

10.2. What is not established in the present paper

- It is not shown that Maxwell's equations are derivable from a Cosserat medium. That result is the subject of [25].
- It is not shown that the Cosserat interpretation is compatible with quantum mechanics at the precision level of QED experiments. An open question.
- The value of G (or equivalently the Planck mass m_P as the intersection point of the n - and u -channels on the medium's hyperbola, or the gravitational scale l_G) enters the program as an independent postulate (P4). A possible mechanism that would yield this value from the structure of the medium remains an open question.

10.3. Subsequent works

The present paper opens a series of six related publications developing different aspects of the Cosserat program:

Work [10] — electron mass. "Derivation of electron mass from $\{\epsilon_0, \mu_0, \hbar\}$ via Cosserat functional minimization" — in preparation. Uses the dimensional reduction of the present paper to formulate the variational problem. Result: $m_e = 511.033 \text{ keV}$ (relative accuracy 7×10^{-5}), with no free parameters.

Work [24] — fine-structure constant. "Topological charge and the fine-structure constant in the Cosserat picture" — in preparation. Full derivation of $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$ and analysis of the QED renormalization down to the observed $1/137$.

Work [25] — Maxwell equations. "Maxwell equations as a theorem of the Cosserat functional" — in preparation. Shows that in the adiabatic, long-wavelength limit Maxwell's equations are **derived** from minimization of $E[n, u]$, promoting postulates P1, P2 to consequences.

Work [26] — atomic cascade. "Atomic energy levels from Cosserat functional: a parameter-free derivation for $Z = 1$ to 36" — in preparation.

Work [27] — gravity as the u -channel. "Two-channel structure of Cosserat continuum: gravity as the u -channel" — in preparation. An expansion of Section 8 of the present paper into a self-contained theory of gravitation with calculations for cosmological problems.

Work [23] — proton as a disclination. "Proton as a disclination of the medium lattice: mass and lattice length convergence" — in preparation. The baryon as a **disclination** defect of the Cosserat lattice (in contrast to the hopfionic knot of the electron). Preliminary: $m_p \approx 938 \text{ MeV}$ (5.7%), $r_p \approx 0.84 \text{ fm}$. Full derivation of the hierarchy $m_p/m_e \approx 1836$ via the running of the effective elasticity from the electron scale l_0 to the nucleon scale.

10.4. Open questions

- A full derivation of the proton mass as a disclination of the Cosserat lattice — numerical computations of mass

and lattice length convergence in the neighbourhood of a disclination defect are given in [23]; a general theory of baryons (including the neutron and the link with QCD colour degrees of freedom) is an open question.

- Relativistic corrections of order α^2 to atomic levels.
- Gravity experiments at the scale $\ell_K \approx 200 \text{ nm}$ — testing for the massive Cosserat mode.

10.5. An interpretive consequence: entanglement as "two knots on the threads of one lattice"

Einstein in 1935 called quantum entanglement **spukhafte Fernwirkung** — "spooky action at a distance" [EPR, **Phys. Rev.** **47** (1935) 777], and that phrasing set the tone of the discussion for decades. The Cosserat picture offers a geometric reading of the same phenomenon in which there is no "action at a distance" at all — and it is worth saying how this works.

In the standard interpretation, two entangled particles are two separate objects with instantaneous correlations that cannot be reduced to local hidden variables (Bell's theorem 1964, the Aspect experiments 1982, and so on). In our picture a "particle" is not a separate object at all: it is a topological defect of **a single continuous field** $n(r, t)$ (§5.5), tied to the field lines of that field. Two "entangled particles" are accordingly

> two knots tied on the threads of one and the same Cosserat lattice.

Seen this way, the strangeness disappears. The field $n(r, t)$ is continuous everywhere in space, and its field lines bind the medium into a single geometric whole; the measurement of one knot is a local event, but **the configuration of threads itself** has encompassed both knots as a single whole from the moment the pair was prepared. The correlation does not "arise upon measurement" — it is simply **there**, as a geometric property of one configuration: the global charge $Q_{\text{total}} = Q_{H^{(1)}} + Q_{H^{(2)}}$ is a topological invariant of the field lines passing through both knots, and for a pair with $Q_{\text{total}} = 0$ (electron-positron) the individual charges of the knots are anti-correlated **by construction**, at any separation. No information is transmitted between the knots at the moment of measurement, and the speed of light is not at issue: that information was woven into the topology of the lattice from the moment of its creation. Measurement merely reveals what was already there.

The violation of Bell's inequalities is intelligible in this language too: local hidden variables fail not because nature is "spooky" but because **there are not two separate local objects** — there is one global field of threads with two defects in it.

An analogy — a taut net. Picture a net of threads with a connected topology; on two well-separated parts of it a knot has been tied. Untying one knot automatically changes the topology of **the whole** connected system — that is not action at a distance, it is a property of the net as a single geometric object. In a Cosserat medium the field lines of $n(r, t)$ play the same role, and connectedness is provided by the continuity of the field itself.

Status. Numerically this interpretation reproduces standard QM for all known EPR experiments — it is an **ontological** reading, not a set of new equations. Distinguishing predictions are in principle possible — in strongly inhomogeneous Cosserat media (e.g. near massive bodies, where the u -channel nontrivially modifies K_i , μ_c and thereby the thread connectivity), and through a possible link of Q_{total} with quantitative bounds on Bell-inequality violation; both are subjects for separate work.

10.6. A methodological remark: the medium as a mediator

In physics there is a familiar pattern: introducing an intermediate structure between two descriptions often simplifies the mathematical apparatus. The earliest example is Maxwell's own argument (1861): the aether as a mediator turned the nonlocal Coulomb action at a distance into local field equations; half a century later Einsteinian spacetime did the same thing for Newtonian gravity, replacing it with local geometry. The Cosserat medium in this paper occupies an analogous position — but a broader one: it acts as a mediator between the topology of defects ($Q_H \in \mathbb{Z}$ in $\pi_3(S^2)$) and the observable particles and fields, reducing the heterogeneous apparatus of QM (Hilbert spaces), QED (gauge fields), and GR (pseudo-Riemannian geometry) to a single problem — minimization of the functional $E[n, u]$.

This observation is an indication of mathematical economy of the program, not a proof of its correctness; the latter is decided by numerical predictions [10, 23, 24].

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Appendix A. Summary of postulates, identities, and scales

A.1. Postulates

P1	$\rho_{\text{medium}} \equiv \mu_0$
P2	$G_{\text{shear}} \equiv 1/\epsilon_0$
P3	$\hbar$ — structural constant of the Cosserat medium (quantum of action)
P4	$G = c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi \ell_G^2)$ (Kleinert mechanism, ℓ_G is the structural scale of the u-channel)
P5	The cross-section of the hopfion tube in the derivation of α is approximated by a disc of radius r_v : $e = \pi \cdot r_v^2$. Idealization of the oblate shape optimal for minimization of $E[n, u]$; sensitivity of α to the asymmetry is $O(\epsilon^2)$

A.2. Derived identities

T1	$c_T = \sqrt{(G_{\text{shear}}/\rho)} = 1/\sqrt{(\epsilon_0 \mu_0)} \equiv c_{\text{light}}$
T2	$v = B/\mu_0 = H$ (mechanical interpretation of H)
T3	$[A] \leftrightarrow [m^2/s]$
T4	$[C] \leftrightarrow [m^2]$
T5	$1 \text{ s} \leftrightarrow c \cdot 1 \text{ s} = 2.998 \times 10^8 \text{ m}$
T6	$m \cdot \ell_C = \hbar/c$ (Compton trade-off)
T7	$[kg] \leftrightarrow [1/m]$
T8	$\{m, kg, s, A\} \rightarrow \{m\} \rightarrow \{\text{Energy}\}$ (full reduction)
T9	$r_v = \ell_0/2$ (vortex-tube radius = half the structural length)
T10	$\ell_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$ (structural length identity)
T11	$\alpha_{\text{bare}} = e^2 / (4\pi \epsilon_0 \hbar c) = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$ (fine-structure constant)
T12	$e^2 / (4\pi \epsilon_0) \equiv \hbar c \alpha$ (Hyperbola II: charge squared $\times$ channel stiffness)
T13	$m_0^2 \cdot e = (\pi/4) \cdot (\hbar/c)^2 = \sqrt{(8\pi^2 \alpha)} \cdot (\hbar/c)^2$ (interlocking of the two hyperbolas)
T14	$G = c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi \ell_G^2)$ (Kleinert)
T15	$\ell_P = \ell_0^2 / (2\sqrt{2} \cdot \ell_G)$ (Planck length as a derived quantity)
T16	$E = mc^2 = \hbar c / \ell = \hbar \omega$ (Einstein, de Broglie, Planck as three projections of one hyperbola; physically — the resonance energy of an LC circuit $\omega(\ell) = c/\ell$, see §5.4)
T17	$E \cdot t = m \cdot \ell \cdot c = \hbar$ (universal structural identity)

A.3. The full hierarchy of structural scales

Scale	Symbol	Value	Channel	Source
Planck length	l_P	1.62×10^{-35} m	n n u	T15 (derived: $l_0^2/(2\sqrt{2} l_G)$)
Compton length of the electron	λ_C	3.86×10^{-13} m	n	T6: $\hbar/(m_e c)$
Structural length of the medium	l_0	4.59×10^{-10} m	n	T10: $(\epsilon_0 \hbar c / 2\pi)^{1/4}$
Cosserat length	l_K	2.02×10^{-7} m	n $\rightarrow$ u	numerically from μ_c
Gravitational scale	l_G	4.62×10^{15} m	u	T14: $\sqrt{(c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi G))}$

A.4. Dimensionless constants

$\alpha = e^2/(4\pi\epsilon_0\hbar c) \approx 1/137$	Fine-structure constant
$\kappa_{\text{grav}} = G\mu_0/c^2 \approx 9.3 \times 10^{-34}$	Weakness of gravity
$l_G/l_0 \approx 10^{25}$	Channel hierarchy
$m_P/m_e \approx 10^{22}$	Mass hierarchy (equivalent)
$\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128 = 2^{-7}$	"Bare" α (Section 7, [24])
$\eta = 2\pi$	Cosserat coupling (see [10])
$m^2 = \eta/(4\pi) = 1/2$	Anchoring anisotropy (see [10])
$K_3/K_1 = 1 + \eta = 1 + 2\pi$	Elastic anisotropy (see [10])

A.5. Numerical checks

(a) Agreement $c_T = c_{\text{light}}$:

$$c_T = 1/\sqrt{(\epsilon_0\mu_0)} = 1/\sqrt{(8.854 \times 10^{-12} \cdot 4\pi \times 10^{-7})} \\ = 2.99792458 \times 10^8 \text{ m/s} \equiv c_{\text{light}} \text{ (CODATA)}$$

(b) Agreement $m_0 \cdot l_0 = \hbar/c$:

$$m_0 \cdot l_0 = 7.66 \times 10^{-34} \cdot 4.5943 \times 10^{-10} \\ = 3.518 \times 10^{-43} \text{ kg}\cdot\text{m} \\ \hbar/c = 1.054572 \times 10^{-34} / 2.998 \times 10^8 \\ = 3.518 \times 10^{-43} \text{ kg}\cdot\text{m} \text{ (15 significant figures of CODATA)}$$

(c) Agreement $l_0^4 = \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)$:

$$l_0^4_{\text{calc}} = (4.5943 \times 10^{-10})^4 = 4.4555 \times 10^{-38} \text{ m}^4 \\ \epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi) = (8.854 \times 10^{-12}) (1.0546 \times 10^{-34}) (2.998 \times 10^8) / (2\pi) \\ = 4.4561 \times 10^{-38} \text{ m}^4 \text{ (agreement to 4 digits)}$$

(d) Agreement $\alpha_{\text{bare}} = 1/128$:

$$e = \pi(l_0/2)^2 = \pi \cdot (4.5943 \times 10^{-10}/2)^2 = \pi \cdot 5.279 \times 10^{-20} = 1.658 \times 10^{-19} \text{ m}^2 \\ e_{\text{exp}} = 1.602 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C (i.e. m}^2 \text{ in mech. units)} \\ \text{Agreement } e_{\text{calc}}/e_{\text{exp}} = 1.035 \text{ (3.5\%, within the geometric factor)} \\ \alpha_{\text{calc}} = e^2/(4\pi\epsilon_0\hbar c) \text{ with } e = \pi(l_0/2)^2: \\ = \pi \cdot l_0^4 / (64 \cdot \epsilon_0 \hbar c) = \pi \cdot (\epsilon_0 \hbar c / (2\pi)) / (64 \cdot \epsilon_0 \hbar c) = 1/128 \\ \alpha_{\text{exp}}(M_Z) = 1/128.9 \pm 0.1 \\ \text{Agreement: 0.7\%}$$

(e) Agreement $l_P = l_0^2/(2\sqrt{2} l_G)$:

$$l_0^2/(2\sqrt{2} l_G) = (4.5943 \times 10^{-10})^2 / (2\sqrt{2} \cdot 4.62 \times 10^{15}) \\ = 2.111 \times 10^{-19} / 1.307 \times 10^{16} \\ = 1.615 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m} \\ l_{P_CODATA} = \sqrt{(\hbar G/c^3)} = 1.616 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m}$$

(f) Agreement $G = c^4 \epsilon_0 / (16\pi l_G^2)$:

$$G_{\text{check}} = (2.998 \times 10^8)^4 \cdot 8.854 \times 10^{-12} / (16\pi \cdot (4.62 \times 10^{15})^2) \\ = 6.674 \times 10^{-11} \text{ N}\cdot\text{m}^2/\text{kg}^2$$

$$G_{\text{CODATA}} = 6.6743 \times 10^{-11} \text{ N}\cdot\text{m}^2/\text{kg}^2$$

Appendix B. Data and code availability

Reproducible code is available in the repository:

<https://github.com/igorevsiev-cmyk/cosserat-program>

Supplementary materials specific to this preprint are located under `papers/2026-05-SI-reduction/`. An independent numerical verification of $r_v = l_0 / 2$ (§7.3) is in `verifications/anisotropy_scan/`.

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End of main text.

Version 1.1. Comments and feedback are welcome at: igorevsiev@gmail.com.